UNIT 1: Fundamentals of Communication

1. Meaning and Process of Communication

Meaning

The word **communication,** derived from the Latin root *communis,* translates to "to share" or "to make common." At its core, communication is a **continuous, dynamic two-way process of exchanging information, ideas, thoughts, feelings, and intentions** between two or more individuals to establish a mutual, shared understanding.

The Communication Process (Key Elements)

The communication loop consists of several sequential components working together:

1. **Sender (Source):** The initiator who conceives an idea, objective, or information to be shared.
2. **Encoding:** The mental conversion of raw ideas or data into symbolic form (words, vocal inflection, body language, or visual diagrams).
3. **Message:** The tangible or audible output generated after encoding—the actual content or meaning intended for transmission.
4. **Channel (Medium):** The physical or digital medium chosen to transmit the message (e.g., face-to-face dialogue, written email, videoconference, telephone).
5. **Receiver:** The individual, group, or audience who intercepts the message.
6. **Decoding:** The cognitive process where the receiver interprets and translates the received symbols back into meaningful concepts.
7. **Feedback:** The response, acknowledgment, or counter-message sent back to the sender. This step completes the interactive loop and validates whether the original message was decoded accurately.
8. **Noise:** Any internal or external barrier, interference, or distortion occurring at any stage that impedes clear reception and understanding.

2. Types of Communication

A. Verbal Communication

Verbal communication relies on spoken language to transmit meaning across interpersonal or public contexts.

- **Primary Channels:** One-on-one dialogues, formal presentations, lectures, meetings, telephone calls, and audio conferences.

- **Key Advantages:** High speed, direct emotional engagement, immediate feedback, and rapid ability to clarify misinterpretations.
- **Core Limitations:** Leaves no verifiable physical record unless recorded; vulnerable to memory decay and serial distortion through multiple administrative layers.

B. Non-Verbal Communication

Non-verbal communication encompasses all message exchanges carried out without spoken or written words. Research demonstrates that non-verbal cues account for the predominant share of emotional and relational meaning in human interaction.

1. Body Language (Kinesics)

Kinesics refers to the study of visible bodily movements, postures, and physical behaviors:

- **Facial Expressions:** The primary interface for displaying universal human emotions, such as joy, sadness, fear, surprise, disgust, and anger.
- **Eye Contact (Oculesics):** Regulates conversation turns, indicates attention, and establishes confidence or authority. Perceptions vary culturally: steady eye contact denotes honesty in Western business, whereas prolonged direct gaze can be interpreted as insubordination in specific East Asian hierarchies.
- **Gestures:**
    - *Emblems:* Gestures possessing precise verbal translations (e.g., thumbs-up or nodding).
    - *Illustrators:* Accompany speech to visually reinforce points (e.g., sketching shapes in the air).
    - *Adaptors:* Subconscious tension-release behaviors (e.g., fidgeting with pens, shifting weight, touching hair).
- **Posture and Stance:** Open postures (uncrossed limbs, leaning slightly forward) project confidence and receptivity; closed postures (crossed arms, slouched shoulders, angled-away torso) signal defensiveness, fatigue, or detachment.
- **Proxemics (Spatial Distances):** The communicative use of interpersonal space:
    - *Intimate Zone:* 0 to 1.5 feet (confidential, close personal connections)
    - *Personal Zone:* 1.5 to 4 feet (casual interactions and peer conversations)
    - *Social Zone:* 4 to 12 feet (workplace interactions, professional group meetings)
    - *Public Zone:* 12 feet and beyond (public addresses and lecture halls)
- **Haptics:** Communication through touch, such as handshakes, which must align with professional decorum and socio-cultural boundaries.

2. Paralanguage (Vocalics)

Paralanguage examines the vocal characteristics of speech separate from the literal words spoken:

- **Pitch:** High pitch often communicates nervousness, surprise, or inquiry, while a lower, modulated pitch conveys composure, gravitas, and authority.
- **Tone:** The emotional resonance or attitude carried by the voice (e.g., warm, sarcastic, cold, enthusiastic, condescending).
- **Pace / Rate of Delivery:** Rapid delivery may indicate anxiety or acute urgency; a measured, rhythmic cadence suggests confidence and deliberate thought.
- **Volume:** Controlled vocal amplitude used for emphasis, clarity, and projection without resorting to aggressive shouting.
- **Strategic Pauses & Silence:** Intentional pauses draw attention to key takeaways and afford processing time; awkward or prolonged pauses may register as unpreparedness or friction.
- **Vocal Fillers:** Overuse of sounds such as "um," "ah," or "you know" can detract from perceived expertise and clarity.

C. Written Communication

Written communication entails transmitting symbolic language across printed or digital media, including emails, formal memoranda, technical documentation, operational reports, and policy guidelines.

- **Key Advantages:** Produces an auditable, archival record; supports legal verification; enables careful drafting, structuring, and editing.
- **Core Limitations:** Void of non-verbal cues, making tone easily prone to negative interpretation; inherently slower feedback cycle compared to real-time discussion.

D. Visual Communication

Visual communication incorporates graphical representations, diagrams, flowcharts, data graphs, iconography, and multimedia slide decks.

- **Key Advantages:** Condenses dense analytical data into digestible patterns; transcends native language barriers; markedly improves cognitive retention and recall.
- **Core Limitations:** Requires specialized graphic literacy; poorly designed graphics can introduce ambiguity or mislead the audience.

3. Barriers to Communication

Communication barriers disrupt or corrupt message encoding, transmission, or decoding. The table below analyzes three critical categories:

Barrier Type	Underlying Causes & Mechanics	Typical Manifestations	Remediation Strategies
Psychological	Internal cognitive filters, intense emotional states, confirmation bias, interpersonal distrust, and perceptual distortion.	Defensive listening, premature judgment, dismissiveness due to ego, or anxiety-driven cognitive overload.	Cultivate self-awareness, practice emotional regulation, postpone sensitive discussions during high stress, and build psychological safety.
Physical	Material and environmental constraints, geographical distance, acoustic interference, and technological malfunction.	Loud machinery, partitioned office cubicles, unstable network bandwidth, or poor microphone quality during calls.	Optimize room acoustics, select distraction-free environments, test audiovisual equipment in advance, and adopt ergonomic meeting arrangements.
Cultural	Divergent cultural norms, ethnocentric assumptions, varying power-distance values, and language idioms.	Misunderstanding local slang or colloquialisms, friction between high-context and low-context communicators, and conflicting body language	Use clear, non-idiomatic language, foster intercultural competence, suspend cultural assumptions, and establish explicit feedback loops.

Barrier Type	Underlying Causes & Mechanics	Typical Manifestations	Remediation Strategies
		interpretations.	

4. Active Listening Skills

Active listening is a disciplined, conscious practice that requires the listener to fully absorb, understand, retain, and thoughtfully respond to both verbal content and non-verbal cues.

Core Techniques for Mastery

- **Physical Attending:** Face the speaker squarely, maintain appropriate eye contact, nod affirmatively, and eliminate digital distractions (e.g., closing unnecessary screens or muting phones).
- **Suspension of Judgment:** Resist formulating counterarguments or premature solutions while the speaker is conveying their thoughts; allow them to conclude without interruption.
- **Paraphrasing & Restatement:** Synthesize the speaker's key ideas in your own words to confirm alignment (e.g., *"If I understand correctly, your primary concern is the resource constraint rather than the revised schedule; is that right?"*).
- **Clarifying Probing:** Employ open-ended, non-threatening questions to deepen understanding rather than leading questions (e.g., *"Could you elaborate on how that affected project dependencies?"*).
- **Empathetic Validation:** Acknowledge underlying emotions and frustrations before moving to problem-solving (e.g., *"I recognize how challenging managing that sudden change was for your team."*).

5. Diversity and Inclusion in Communication

Inclusive communication creates an environment of equity and psychological safety, ensuring that every participant, regardless of background or identity, can engage meaningfully.

Key Principles

- **Gender-Neutral and Bias-Free Vocabulary:** Replace exclusionary terms with modern inclusive language (e.g., utilize *chairperson* instead of *chairman*, *workforce* or *personnel* instead of *manpower*, and honor individual self-identification preferences).

- **Navigating Context Styles:**
    - *Low-Context Communication (e.g., Germany, USA):* Direct, explicit, precise, and literal; responsibility for clarity rests heavily on the speaker.
    - *High-Context Communication (e.g., Japan, Middle East):* Implicit, heavily layered with context, non-verbal subtleties, hierarchy, and shared background; reading between the lines is critical.
- **Mitigating Unconscious Stereotyping:** Avoid generalizations based on nationality, ethnicity, gender, age, or accent. Actively invite quieter or underrepresented participants into discussions.
- **Accessible Communication Design:** Provide captions and transcripts for multimedia assets, ensure high color contrast in slide decks and visual documentation, and refrain from using culturally specific idioms, sports metaphors, or unnecessary corporate jargon.

UNIT 2 & 3: APPLIED GRAMMAR AND VOCABULARY SKILLS

PARTS OF SPEECH

SECTION 1:

1. Nouns:

- **Uncountable / Invariant Nouns**

  Exam Rule: Nouns such as equipment, baggage, furniture, information, scenery, advice, machinery, software, and feedback are uncountable. They never take indefinite articles (a/an) and never take a plural '-s'.

  Incorrect: The client asked us to share all the soft-wares and informations.

  Correct: The client asked us to share all the software and information.

  Corporate / Placement Application: *Crucial in technical documentation and executive client summaries.*

- **Nouns Plural in Form but Singular in Construction**

  Exam Rule: Words like news, politics, ethics, mathematics, summons, and series end in '-s' but take a singular verb when treated as a discipline, single entity, or official document.

  Incorrect: Ethics are a crucial aspect of machine learning deployment.

  Correct: Ethics is a crucial aspect of machine learning deployment.

  Corporate / Placement Application: *Note: 'Summons' is singular (plural: summonses). A court issued a summons, not a summon.*

- **Hyphenated Compound Nouns as Modifiers**

  Exam Rule: When a compound number or measurement acts as an adjective preceding a noun, the modifying noun never takes plural form.

  Incorrect: The team submitted a twenty-pages report to the stakeholders.

  Correct: The team submitted a twenty-page report to the stakeholders.

  Corporate / Placement Application: *Common in technical proposal reviews: 'a three-hour meeting', 'a five-member panel'.*

2. Pronouns: Order, Case, and Antecedent

- **Pronoun Case Following 'Between' and Other Prepositions**

  Exam Rule: Prepositions govern pronouns strictly in the objective case (me, him, her, us, them), never in the subjective/nominative case (I, he, she, we, they).

Incorrect: Between you and I, the deployment is not going to meet the deadline.

Correct: **Between you and me, the deployment is not going to meet the deadline.**

Corporate / Placement Application: *One of the top 5 most frequently tested errors in campus placement tests.*

- **Gerund Possessive Case Precedence**

Exam Rule: A gerund (verbal noun ending in -ing) must be preceded by a possessive adjective/pronoun (my, his, her, their, your), not an objective pronoun.

Incorrect: Management disapproved of him escalating the Jira issue directly to the VP.

Correct: **Management disapproved of his escalating the Jira issue directly to the VP.**

Corporate / Placement Application: *Essential in corporate emails: 'Thank you for your coming' or 'I appreciate your guiding us'.*

- **Relative Pronoun Agreement with 'One of those who...'**

Exam Rule: In expressions like 'one of the [plural noun] who/that [verb]', the relative pronoun refers to the plural antecedent, so the subordinate verb must be plural. However, 'the only one of the...' takes a singular verb.

Incorrect: Rohan is one of the project architects who has built scalable cloud pipelines.

Correct: **Rohan is one of the project architects who have built scalable cloud pipelines.**

Corporate / Placement Application: *Exception: 'Rohan is the only one of the architects who has built it.'*

3. Verbs: Mood, Causatives, and Stative Verbs

- **Subjunctive Mood in Corporate Motions & Mandates**

Exam Rule: Verbs expressing formal demand, recommendation, urgency, or necessity (insist, recommend, demand, request, mandate, advise) followed by a 'that'-clause take the subjunctive base form of the verb (bare V1 without -s or modal).

Incorrect: The compliance auditor insisted that every developer signs the NDA immediately.

Correct: **The compliance auditor insisted that every developer sign the NDA immediately.**

Corporate / Placement Application: *Frequent in governance, project charters, and formal HR communications.*

- **Causative Verbs (Make, Have, Let vs. Get, Help)**

Exam Rule: 'Make', 'let', and 'have' take a bare infinitive (V1) when the object actively performs the action. 'Get' requires a full infinitive (to + V1).

Incorrect: The Scrum Master made the team to attend the retrospective at 9:00 AM.

Correct: **The Scrum Master made the team attend the retrospective at 9:00 AM.**

Corporate / Placement Application: *Compare: 'The manager got the team to refactor the legacy module.'*

- **Stative Verbs in Continuous Tenses**

Exam Rule: Verbs denoting mental states, ownership, sensory perception, and conditions (know, believe, understand, belong, appear, comprise, seem, hear) are stative and cannot take continuous aspect in formal English.

Incorrect: I am understanding the client's architecture now.

Correct: I understand the client's architecture now.

Corporate / Placement Application: *Eliminates frequent colloquial errors in candidate interviews.*

4. Adjectives: Degree, Order, and Double Comparatives

- **Double Comparatives and Superlatives**

  Exam Rule: Never combine 'more/most' with an adjective that already has '-er/-est'.

  Incorrect: This cloud server is more faster than our on-premise blade server.

  Correct: This cloud server is faster than our on-premise blade server.

  Corporate / Placement Application: *Standard error-spotting item in TCS NQT and SSC CGL.*

- **Adjectives of Absolute Condition**

  Exam Rule: Words like unique, perfect, complete, universal, chief, extreme, fatal, and dead denote absolute binary states and cannot take comparative/superlative qualifiers.

  Incorrect: This is the most unique framework among all AI engines.

  Correct: This is a unique framework among all AI engines.

  Corporate / Placement Application: *In interviews, avoid saying 'most ideal candidate'; say 'the ideal candidate'.*

- **OSASCOMP Order of Adjectives**

  Exam Rule: When multiple adjectives modify a noun, maintain standard order: Opinion → Size → Age → Shape → Color → Origin → Material → Purpose.

  Incorrect: The firm ordered ten plastic blue circular cheap office chairs.

  Correct: The firm ordered ten cheap circular blue plastic office chairs.

  Corporate / Placement Application: *Crucial for descriptive technical documentation and product specs.*

5. Adverbs: Inversion, Linking Verbs, and Split Infinitives

- **Inversion After Restrictive / Negative Adverbs**

  Exam Rule: When a sentence begins with a negative or restrictive adverb (seldom, rarely, scarcely, hardly, never, little, nor), invert the auxiliary verb before the subject.

  Incorrect: Seldom we have seen such severe throughput bottlenecks in load testing.

  Correct: Seldom have we seen such severe throughput bottlenecks in load testing.

  Corporate / Placement Application: *Creates authoritative, sophisticated presentation and written communication.*

- **Adverbs vs. Predicate Adjectives with Linking / Copular Verbs**

Exam Rule: Verbs of sense and state (look, seem, appear, sound, taste, smell, feel, remain) take predicate adjectives, not adverbs, when describing the subject.

Incorrect: The software architecture looks very smoothly and soundly.

Correct: The software architecture looks very smooth and sound.

Corporate / Placement Application: *Contrast: 'The engine runs smoothly' (action verb + adverb) vs. 'The engine smells hot' (linking verb + adjective).*

- **Misplaced Modifiers ('Only', 'Almost')**

Exam Rule: Adverbs like 'only' and 'almost' must sit immediately preceding the specific word they modify, otherwise the entire semantic meaning changes.

Incorrect: The engineer only resolved three bugs yesterday. (Implies he did nothing else)

Correct: The engineer resolved only three bugs yesterday. (Accurately specifies the quantity: 3 bugs)

Corporate / Placement Application: *High error frequency in corporate SLAs and project delivery scopes.*

6. Prepositions: Idiomatic Collocations and Phrasal Verbs

- **Transitive Verbs Misused with Prepositions**

Exam Rule: Transitive verbs directly govern their objects without intervening prepositions: discuss (not discuss about), emphasize (not emphasize on), order (not order for), stress (not stress on), marry (not marry with), resemble (not resemble to), request (not request for).

Incorrect: During the meeting, the CTO emphasized on microservice security.

Correct: During the meeting, the CTO emphasized microservice security.

Corporate / Placement Application: *Heavily penalized in verbal assessments and campus group discussions.*

- **Fixed Preposition Collocations in Technical & Business Contexts**

Exam Rule: Comply with (not to), adhere to (not with), refrain from (not to), differ from (not than), devoid of (not with), conducive to (not for), eligible for (not to).

Incorrect: The junior tester failed to comply to the organizational coding norms.

Correct: The junior tester failed to comply with the organizational coding norms.

Corporate / Placement Application: *Vital for written corporate policies, security compliance, and SLAs.*

- **Between vs. Among and Dual Nuance**

Exam Rule: Use 'between' for distinct, individual entities (even if more than two when negotiating reciprocal relationships, treaties, or trade pacts), and 'among' for non-distinct collective groups of three or more.

Incorrect: The cloud provider split bandwidth among the two primary data centers.

Correct: The cloud provider split bandwidth between the two primary data centers.

Corporate / Placement Application: *Note: 'Negotiations between India, Japan, and the USA' is grammatically correct.*

7. Conjunctions: Correlative Symmetry and Redundancy

- **Parallelism in Correlative Conjunctions**

  Exam Rule: Correlative pairs (either...or, neither...nor, not only...but also, both...and) must be followed by identical parts of speech.

  Incorrect: The lead developer not only wrote the backend API but also the front-end UI.

  Correct: The lead developer wrote not only the backend API but also the front-end UI.

  Corporate / Placement Application: *A staple of sentence correction sections in GMAT, CAT, and corporate exams.*

- **Redundant Connectors (Lest...Should, Although...Yet, Because/As...So)**

  Exam Rule: 'Lest' means 'for fear that' and governs 'should' or subjunctive bare V1; it never takes 'not' or 'will'. Never pair 'because/since/as' with 'therefore/so' in the same sentence.

  Incorrect: Because the server failed, therefore the deployment was aborted.

  Correct: Because the server failed, the deployment was aborted. (OR: The server failed, so the deployment was aborted.)

  Corporate / Placement Application: *Double conjunctions are strictly forbidden in formal English.*

- **Negative Adverbs Paired with When vs. Than**

  Exam Rule: 'Hardly' and 'scarcely' pair strictly with 'when'. 'No sooner' pairs strictly with 'than' (never 'when' or 'then').

  Incorrect: No sooner had the code compiled when the unit tests threw a failure.

  Correct: No sooner had the code compiled than the unit tests threw a failure.

  Corporate / Placement Application: *Top tested grammatical pair across all competitive examinations.*

8. Interjections & Conversational Discourse Markers

- **Register and Tone Control in Corporate Communication**

  Exam Rule: Interjections denote sudden emotional outbursts (alas, bravo, ouch). In professional corporate writing and formal exams, emotive interjections are replaced with precise formal adverbs and tone markers.

  Incorrect: Alas! The staging server crashed right before the client demo.

  Correct: Regrettably, the staging server crashed immediately prior to the client demo.

  Corporate / Placement Application: *Teaches engineering students how to transition from informal speech to executive communication.*

Part of Speech

Functional Shift: Same Word, Different Functions

Word	Part of Speech 1 & Example	Part of Speech 2 & Example	Competitive Exam Significance
Fast	Adjective: 'He is a fast programmer.'	Adverb: 'He runs fast.' (Never 'fastly')	'Fastly' does not exist in standard English.
Hard	Adjective: 'It was a hard task.'	Adverb: 'She worked hard.' vs. 'Hardly' (scarcely)	'Hard' vs. 'Hardly' radically alters sentence meaning.
Since	Preposition: 'Working here since 2021.'	Conjunction: 'Since the API is down, pause tests.'	Determines comma placement and tense structure.
Down	Preposition: 'Walk down the hall.'	Adjective: 'The system is down.' / Verb: 'Down tools.'	Common in multi-part speech identification questions.
Before	Preposition: 'Before noon.'	Conjunction: 'Check logs before you deploy.'	Governs gerunds when acting as a preposition.

SECTION 2: 50 EXAM-STANDARD PRACTICE QUESTIONS

Directions (Q1–Q30): In each sentence, find the specific section containing a grammatical error. If there is no error, mark (E).
Directions (Q31–Q50): Choose the grammatically and idiomatically correct option for corporate context.

1. The project manager insisted (A) / that the newly recruited tester (B) / refactors the module (C) / before pushing to GitHub. (D) / No Error (E)
2. All the furnitures and IT equipments (A) / in the newly opened incubation hub (B) / were imported from Germany (C) / at significant expenditure. (D) / No Error (E)
3. Between you and I, (A) / the chief technical officer (B) / will not approve the proposed budget (C) / for cloud migration this quarter. (D) / No Error (E)
4. The human resource team (A) / strongly objected to him (B) / arriving late for client meetings (C) / without prior notification. (D) / No Error (E)
5. She is one of the few (A) / female systems engineers who (B) / has consistently outperformed (C) / the established quarterly benchmarks. (D) / No Error (E)

6. During the town hall, (A) / the managing director (B) / discussed about the upcoming merger (C) / with our strategic partner. (D) / No Error (E)

7. Seldom our engineering team has (A) / encountered such a complex bug (B) / during the final release phase (C) / of a production cycle. (D) / No Error (E)

8. The front-end engineer not only (A) / designed the interactive UI (B) / but also implemented (C) / the full authentication workflow. (D) / No Error (E)

9. No sooner had the release pipeline (A) / executed the deployment scripts (B) / when the load balancer (C) / registered server downtime. (D) / No Error (E)

10. He is senior than (A) / all the other tech leads (B) / in our division by at least (C) / three promotional cycles. (D) / No Error (E)

11. The new enterprise software (A) / is more superior to (B) / the legacy system we implemented (C) / five years ago. (D) / No Error (E)

12. The delivery lead along with (A) / twelve senior architects (B) / are scheduled to present (C) / the solution blueprint tomorrow. (D) / No Error (E)

13. Neither of the five modules (A) / submitted by the intern (B) / met the rigorous code-quality standards (C) / set by the team. (D) / No Error (E)

14. His presentation sounded very smoothly, (A) / but upon closer technical inspection, (B) / the system architecture (C) / proved deeply flawed. (D) / No Error (E)

15. Our firm entered into (A) / a five-years maintenance agreement (B) / with the enterprise cloud provider (C) / to curtail recurring overheads. (D) / No Error (E)

16. You should work hard (A) / lest you will miss (B) / the strict sprint deadline (C) / agreed upon with the client. (D) / No Error (E)

17. I am knowing the exact reason (A) / why the automated test scripts (B) / failed during regression testing (C) / late last night. (D) / No Error (E)

18. The tech recruiter made the candidate (A) / to solve three complex algorithmic puzzles (B) / within forty-five minutes (C) / without using external libraries. (D) / No Error (E)

19. Because the network switch failed, (A) / therefore the entire offshore development center (B) / was cut off from the main corporate server (C) / for over four hours. (D) / No Error (E)

20. The principal architect told us (A) / that the quantum algorithm (B) / was the most unique solution (C) / to our cryptographic requirements. (D) / No Error (E)

21. The Scrum Master distributed (A) / the bonus pool equally (B) / between all members (C) / of the cross-functional agile squad. (D) / No Error (E)

22. Unless the candidate does not produce (A) / the original educational certificates (B) / the offer letter will remain (C) / formally withheld. (D) / No Error (E)

23. Neither the product owner (A) / nor the software developers (B) / was satisfied with the outcome (C) / of the client acceptance test. (D) / No Error (E)

24. She gave me two ten-rupees notes (A) / to pay the courier delivery driver (B) / for the urgent shipment (C) / of microcontrollers. (D) / No Error (E)

25. He only wrote three test cases (A) / during the entire working day, (B) / causing significant backlog (C) / in the QA pipeline. (D) / No Error (E)

26. If the CTO was present (A) / at the emergency board meeting, (B) / he would have vetoed (C) / the immediate infrastructure shutdown. (D) / No Error (E)

27. Scarcely had the keynote speaker (A) / commenced his address (B) / than the audio equipment malfunctioned (C) / across the auditorium. (D) / No Error (E)

28. The compliance officer insisted (A) / that our security policy (B) / must strictly comply to (C) / ISO-27001 parameters. (D) / No Error (E)

29. In today's competitive job market, (A) / an applicant must know (B) / to code fluently in at least (C) / two backend languages. (D) / No Error (E)

30. The panel evaluated his performance (A) / and concluded that he was (B) / the most hardworking and wiser (C) / of all shortlisted candidates. (D) / No Error (E)

31. The compliance department mandated that every software engineer _____ the cybersecurity protocols.
(A) follows (B) follow (C) followed (D) will follow

32. The executive committee expressed strong appreciation for _____ the mission-critical cloud outage over the weekend.
(A) him resolving (B) his resolving (C) he resolving (D) him having resolved

33. Neither the infrastructure team nor the network administrator _____ able to locate the corrupted data packets.
(A) were (B) was (C) are (D) have been

34. The data pipeline handles incoming streams _____ than our previous open-source framework.
(A) more quickly (B) more quicker (C) quicklier (D) most quick

35. The tech startup signed a _____ lease for their corporate headquarters in Whitefield.
(A) five-years (B) five year's (C) five-year (D) five of years

36. Please ensure that all API endpoints are strictly compliant _____ modern OAuth 2.0 standards.
(A) to (B) with (C) on (D) against

37. _____ had the DevOps engineer initiated the database sync _____ the primary server threw an I/O error.
(A) Hardly, than (B) No sooner, than (C) Scarcely, than (D) No sooner, when

38. The team could not attend the agile demo because they had _____ bandwidth due to the production fire.
(A) few (B) little (C) a few (D) many

39. You should back up all transactional records _____ an unforeseen hardware malfunction occur.
(A) lest (B) unless (C) although (D) despite

40. The company made all prospective software interns _____ a legally binding non-disclosure agreement.
(A) to sign (B) signing (C) sign (D) signed

41. He is the only one of the lead architects who _____ consistently delivered bug-free deployments.
(A) have (B) has (C) are (D) were

42. During the technical round, the interviewer asked the candidate to explain _____ a binary search tree.
(A) to balance (B) how to balance (C) balancing of (D) how balancing

43. The newly launched microservices platform operates extremely _____ under concurrent multi-user stress.
(A) smooth (B) smoothly (C) smoother (D) more smoothly

44. A confidential corporate memo was circulated _____ the two managing partners.
(A) among (B) between (C) amidst (D) within

45. I look forward to _____ your technical presentation during the upcoming campus symposium.
(A) attend (B) attending (C) attended (D) have attended

46. The company decided to terminate the vendor's contract because their deliverables were consistently _____ to market standards.
(A) inferior than (B) inferior to (C) more inferior to (D) most inferior than

47. The newly bought office _____ arrived yesterday afternoon in damaged condition.
(A) equipments (B) equipment (C) pieces of equipments (D) equipment set

48. The engineering lead was _____ surprised at the unprecedented throughput speed of the prototype.
(A) very (B) much (C) too (D) more

49. He handled the client's aggressive escalation with admirable _____.
(A) patient (B) patience (C) patiently (D) patientness

50. The panel concluded that she was _____ qualified candidate for the senior systems engineer vacancy.
(A) the more (B) the most (C) most (D) more

SECTION 3: DETAILED ANSWER KEY AND EXPLANATIONS

1. (C) — Replace 'refactors' with 'refactor'. Subjunctive mood after verbs of demand/insistence requires bare V1 (Subject + base verb).

2. (A) — Replace 'furnitures and IT equipments' with 'furniture and IT equipment'. Both are uncountable invariant nouns.

3. (A) — Replace 'Between you and I' with 'Between you and me'. Prepositions take pronouns in the objective case.

4. (B) — Replace 'objected to him' with 'objected to his'. Gerunds (arriving) require a possessive determiner/pronoun.

5. (C) — Replace 'has consistently' with 'have consistently'. In 'one of the [plural noun] who', the antecedent is plural ('engineers').

6. (C) — Replace 'discussed about' with 'discussed'. 'Discuss' is a transitive verb governing a direct object without 'about'.

7. (A) — Replace 'Seldom our engineering team has' with 'Seldom has our engineering team'. Restrictive negative adverbs require inversion.

8. (A) — Place 'not only' symmetrically: 'designed not only the interactive UI but also implemented...'. Correlatives must balance parts of speech.

9. (C) — Replace 'when' with 'than'. 'No sooner' pairs strictly with 'than' (never 'when').

10. (A) — Replace 'senior than' with 'senior to'. Latin comparatives ending in -ior govern 'to'.

11. (B) — Replace 'more superior to' with 'superior to'. Superior is an absolute Latin comparative; double comparative 'more' is redundant.

12. (C) — Replace 'are scheduled' with 'is scheduled'. Parenthetical phrases ('along with...') do not alter the singular subject ('delivery lead').

13. (A) — Replace 'Neither' with 'None'. 'Neither' applies strictly to two entities; use 'none' for three or more.

14. (A) — Replace 'sounded very smoothly' with 'sounded very smooth'. 'Sound' is a linking/copular verb requiring a predicate adjective.

15. (B) — Replace 'five-years' with 'five-year'. Hyphenated compound nouns acting as adjectival modifiers remain singular.

16. (B) — Replace 'will miss' with 'should miss' (or bare 'miss'). 'Lest' takes 'should' or subjunctive V1, never 'will'.

17. (A) — Replace 'I am knowing' with 'I know'. 'Know' is a stative verb resisting continuous tenses in formal English.

18. (B) — Replace 'to solve' with 'solve'. Causative verb 'make' takes a bare infinitive (without 'to').

19. (B) — Remove 'therefore'. 'Because' and 'therefore' cannot be used concurrently in the same sentence.

20. (C) — Replace 'the most unique' with 'a unique'. 'Unique' denotes an absolute condition and cannot take comparative/superlative modifiers.

21. (C) — Replace 'between' with 'among'. 'Among' is used for non-distinct collective groups of three or more.

22. (A) — Replace 'does not produce' with 'produces'. 'Unless' already contains negative polarity; double negatives are ungrammatical.

23. (C) — Replace 'was satisfied' with 'were satisfied'. In 'neither...nor', the verb agrees with the closer subject ('software developers').

24. (A) — Replace 'ten-rupees notes' with 'ten-rupee notes'. Compound measurement adjectives remain singular.

25. (A) — Reposition 'only': 'He wrote only three test cases'. 'Only' must sit immediately preceding the quantity modified.

26. (A) — Replace 'If the CTO was' with 'If the CTO were'. Counterfactual conditional clauses require subjunctive 'were'.

27. (C) — Replace 'than' with 'when'. 'Scarcely' and 'hardly' pair strictly with 'when'.

28. (C) — Replace 'comply to' with 'comply with'. Fixed preposition collocation is 'comply with'.

29. (C) — Replace 'to code' with 'how to code'. 'Know' cannot govern a full infinitive directly; it requires 'how to'.

30. (C) — Replace 'wiser' with 'wisest'. Conjoined adjectives modifying the same superlative noun must match in degree ('most hardworking and wisest').

31. (B) — Mandated that... follow. Subjunctive base verb in formal mandate clauses.

32. (B) — His resolving. Gerunds take possessive pronoun modifiers in formal business contexts.

33. (B) — Was. In 'neither...nor', verb agrees with the closer singular subject ('network administrator').

34. (A) — More quickly. Modifies the action verb 'handles' as a comparative adverb.

35. (C) — Five-year. Hyphenated compound adjective preceding the noun 'lease' remains singular.

36. (B) — With. Standard corporate collocation is 'compliant with'.

37. (B) — No sooner, than. Standard correlative pair with auxiliary inversion.

38. (B) — Little. 'Bandwidth' is uncountable and 'little' denotes scarce/insufficient capacity.

39. (A) — Lest. Signifies 'for fear that' or 'to prevent the risk of'.

40. (C) — Sign. Causative 'made' governs a bare infinitive without 'to'.

41. (B) — Has. In 'the only one of the [plural noun] who', the restrictive subject is singular 'one'.

42. (B) — How to balance. 'Know/explain' takes an interrogative particle before an infinitive.

43. (B) — Smoothly. Adverb modifying the action verb 'operates'.

44. (B) — Between. Restricted strictly to two distinct entities ('the two managing partners').

45. (B) — Attending. In 'look forward to', 'to' is a preposition governing a gerund (-ing).

46. (B) — Inferior to. Latin comparatives take 'to' without 'more'.

47. (B) — Equipment. Uncountable noun that never accepts '-s'.

48. (B) — Much. 'Much' modifies past participles ('surprised'); 'very' modifies present participles/positive adjectives.

49. (B) — Patience. The preposition 'with' followed by an adjective requires an abstract noun.

50. (B) — The most. Superlative degree required when evaluating among all applicants.

PART 1: RULES OF COMMON ERRORS IN ENGLISH

Pronoun Order and Cases

Objective Case After "Let"

Rule: When a pronoun follows the transitive verb let, it must always be in the objective case (me, him, her, us, them).

Incorrect: Let he do it.

Correct: **Let him do it.**

Order of Plural Pronouns (1-2-3 Rule)

Rule: When combining two or more plural personal pronouns, arrange them in the sequence: First Person (we) → Second Person (you) → Third Person (they).

Incorrect: You, they and we must go together.

Correct: **We, you and they must go together.**

Order of Singular Pronouns (2-3-1 Rule)

Rule: In normal, positive, or polite contexts, arrange singular personal pronouns in the sequence: Second Person (you) → Third Person (he/she) → First Person (I).

Incorrect: I, you and he must help the needy.

Correct: **You, he and I must help the needy.**

Pronoun After Form of "Be" (Nominative Case)

Rule: A pronoun functioning as a predicate nominative after a linking form of the verb be (am, is, are, was, were) must remain in the nominative case.

Incorrect: I am him. / He was me.

Correct: **I am he. / He was I.**

Subjunctive Pronoun Case

Rule: In hypothetical or counterfactual conditional clauses introduced by if + were, use a nominative case pronoun.

Incorrect: If you were him, you would have accepted the proposal.

Correct: **If you were he, you would have accepted the proposal.**

Subject-Verb and Pronoun Agreement

Correlative Conjunctions with Singular Subjects

Rule: When two singular subjects are connected by either...or or neither...nor, use a singular verb and a singular pronoun.

Incorrect: Neither Sudha nor Rama did their homework.

Correct: **Neither Sudha nor Rama did her homework.**

Correlative Conjunctions with Mixed Numbers

Rule: When subjects joined by or or nor differ in grammatical number, place the plural subject closest to the verb and use a plural verb.

Incorrect: Neither teachers nor principal was present in the assembly.

Correct: Neither the principal nor the teachers were present in the assembly.

Singular Nouns Joined by "And" Referring to the Same Entity

Rule: If two singular nouns connected by and denote the exact same individual, office, or object, use a singular verb and a singular pronoun.

Incorrect: The director and vice chancellor is not diligent in their duties.

Correct: The director and vice chancellor is not diligent in his duties.

Singular Nouns Joined by "And" Referring to Distinct Entities

Rule: If two nouns connected by and refer to two separate individuals or things, use a plural verb and a plural pronoun.

Incorrect: Rama and Sudha are not honest in her dealing.

Correct: Rama and Sudha are not honest in their dealings.

Parenthetical Additions (As well as, Along with, Together with)

Rule: Phrases introduced by along with, together with, as well as, and in addition to are parenthetical modifiers; they do not alter the number of the main subject.

Incorrect: Alisha along with Anil are going for a picnic.

Correct: Alisha along with Anil is going for a picnic.

Distributive Pronouns (Each of, None of)

Rule: Each of or none of followed by a plural noun or pronoun governs a singular verb and a singular pronoun in formal English.

Incorrect: Each of the boys have participated in the game.

Correct: Each of the boys has participated in the game.

Duality Rules: Either/Neither vs. Any/None

Rule: Restrict either and neither strictly to two entities. Employ any, none, or no one when referring to sets of three or more.

Incorrect: Neither of the three girls was present in the class.

Correct: None of the three girls was present in the class.

Relative Pronoun Agreement in Dependent Clauses

Rule: When a relative pronoun (who, which, that) refers to a plural antecedent, the subordinate verb must also be plural.

Incorrect: She is one of the best teachers who has ever taught me.

Correct: She is one of the best teachers who have ever taught me.

Central Concept / Gist Agreement

Rule: When a singular head noun represents the core subject idea, intervening plural prepositional modifiers do not make the verb plural.

Incorrect: Knowledge of maths, science, social studies and economics are required for 10th class students.

Pronunciation of Worcestershire, choir, and penguin are very confusing.

Correct: Knowledge of maths, science, social studies and economics is required for 10th class students.

Pronunciation of Worcestershire, choir, and penguin is very confusing.

Prepositional Usage and Common Errors

Prepositions Governing Gerunds

Rule: A verb placed immediately after a preposition (about, after, at, before, for, from, in, on) must take the gerund form (V1 + ing).

Incorrect: He will meet his parents before leave for France.

Correct: He will meet his parents before leaving for France.

Preposition Placement with Incompatible Adjectives or Verbs

Rule: When two conjoined adjectives or verbs require different prepositions, state both prepositions explicitly.

Incorrect: He is aware and prepared for his duties.

Correct: He is aware of and prepared for his duties.

Direct Preposition with Communication Verbs

Rule: Verbs of communication (suggest, propose, explain, listen, speak, reply) take the preposition to before a personal indirect object.

Incorrect: I suggest you take some rest. (when constructing with an infinitive/indirect object)

Correct: I suggest to you to take some rest.

Transitive Verbs Requiring No Prepositions

Rule: Standard transitive verbs govern direct objects without prepositions (discuss, describe, reach, order, demand, attack, resemble, ridicule).

Incorrect: He ordered for the food. / He demands to his release.

Correct: He ordered the food. / He demands his release.

Omission of Prepositions Before Time Adverbs

Rule: Never use prepositions (on, at, in) directly before time adverbs like today, tomorrow, or yesterday.

Incorrect: I met him on yesterday.

Correct: I met him yesterday.

Modifiers, Adjectives, and Correlative Conjunctions

Correlative Inversion with Negative Adverbs

Rule: Negative adverbs like hardly and scarcely are paired strictly with when (never than or then), with inverted auxiliary-subject order.

Incorrect: Hardly had we stepped out of the home, then it began to rain.

Correct: Hardly had we stepped out of the home when it began to rain.

Parallel Placement of "Not Only... But Also"

Rule: Elements of correlative conjunctions must precede strictly symmetrical grammatical parts of speech.

Incorrect: He not only lost his shoes but also his books.

Correct: He lost not only his shoes but also his books.

Tense with "Ago"

Rule: The time indicator ago is used exclusively with the simple past tense, never with the past perfect.

Incorrect: He had met him two years ago.

Correct: He met him two years ago.

Distribution of "Much" vs. "Very"

Rule: Very modifies present participles and positive degree adjectives. Much modifies past participles and comparative degree adjectives.

Incorrect: The news is much surprising. / I was very surprised at his behavior.

Correct: The news is very surprising. / I was much surprised at his behavior.

Proper Use of "Too"

Rule: Too signifies an unwelcome excess ("more than enough") and should not replace very in simple positive descriptions.

Incorrect: The palace is too pleasant to look at.

Correct: The palace is very pleasant to look at.

Correlation: "Too... to" vs. "So... that"

Rule: Pair too with an infinitive (to), and so with a result clause (that). Do not cross-mix them.

Incorrect: He is too weak that he cannot walk. / He is so weak to walk.

Correct: He is too weak to walk. / He is so weak that he cannot walk.

Distinction: "Elder/Eldest" vs. "Older/Oldest"

Rule: Elder/eldest applies exclusively to members of the same immediate family and does not take than. Older/oldest applies generally to age and takes than.

Incorrect: My older brother is very protective. / He is two years elder to me.

Correct: **My elder brother is very protective. / He is two years older than I am.**

Uniform Degree of Comparison

Rule: Two or more conjoined adjectives modifying the same noun must remain in the identical degree of comparison.

Incorrect: He is the most handsome and wiser student of the class.

Correct: **He is the most handsome and wisest student of the class.**

Absolute Adjectives

Rule: Adjectives describing absolute conditions (unique, ideal, perfect, complete, universal, extreme, chief) cannot accept comparative or superlative modifiers.

Incorrect: He is the most perfect boy. / It is the most complete assignment.

Correct: **He is a perfect boy. / It is a complete assignment.**

Latin Comparatives Taking "To"

Rule: Latin comparative adjectives ending in -ior (inferior, superior, senior, junior, prior) govern the preposition to, not than.

Incorrect: He always felt inferior than his younger sister.

Correct: **He always felt inferior to his younger sister.**

Infinitives and Bare Infinitives

Verbs of Perception and Permission

Rule: Verbs of perception and permission (bid, let, behold, watch, see, feel, make) take a bare infinitive (an infinitive without to).

Incorrect: I watched him to grow. / I let him to cry.

Correct: **I watched him grow. / I let him cry.**

"Know" Followed by Interrogative Particles

Rule: The verb know cannot directly precede a full infinitive; it requires an intervening interrogative particle (how, where, when, why).

Incorrect: I know to drive.

Correct: **I know how to drive.**

Modal Auxiliaries with Bare Infinitive

Rule: Pure modal auxiliaries (can, could, may, might, should, will, would, must, dare not, need not) are followed directly by bare infinitives.

Incorrect: He dare not to speak to me. / He could not to write.

Correct: He dare not speak to me. / He could not write.

Bare Infinitive After "Than" and "But"

Rule: When than or but (meaning except) follows certain verbal expressions, use a bare infinitive.

Incorrect: He had better leave than to stay. / He did nothing but to weep.

Correct: He had better leave than stay. / He did nothing but weep.

Noun Characteristics and Classifications

- **Always Singular Nouns:** Uncountable and invariant nouns take singular verbs and singular pronouns: hair, information, aircraft, furniture, money, advice, sheep, fish, bread.
- **Always Plural Nouns:** Articles of apparel, tools, and instruments made of paired symmetrical halves take plural verbs: scissors, trousers, spectacles, gloves, socks.
- **Collective Nouns:** Collective nouns take a singular verb when operating as a single unified entity, but take a plural verb when individual members act independently or are framed separately.
  - Singular context: The team has won the match.
  - Plural context: The robbers of a band have attacked the city.
- **Material Nouns:** Material nouns (gold, water, brick, stone) are uncountable when denoting substance; use plural forms only when referring to individual physical units.
  - Substance: My house is constructed of brick and stone.
  - Units: Pick up all the bricks and stones from the driveway.

PART 2: Articles: A, An, and The

The Indefinite Article: "A"

Placed before singular countable nouns starting with a consonant sound:

• a book; a university (starts with the consonant sound /juː/); a European (starts with the consonant sound /juː/).

The Indefinite Article: "An"

Placed before singular countable nouns starting with a vowel sound:

• an umbrella; an hour (silent h, vowel sound /aʊər/); an honest man (silent h, vowel sound /ˈɒn.ɪst/).

The Definite Article: "The"

• Specific Reference: Amitabh, the actor of the movie, is the director's favorite.
• Superlative Forms: the best, the most hardworking, the wisest.
• Unique Natural Entities: the sun, the moon, the Ganga, the Himalayas.
• Proper Nouns as Descriptive Metaphors:
  - Incorrect: I love the India.
  - Correct: Ram is the Sachin Tendulkar of my team. / Radha is the Hitler of her class.

PART 3: COMPREHENSIVE TENSE STRUCTURES

Master Tense Matrix

Tense	Affirmative Construction	Negative Construction	Interrogative Construction
Simple Present	Subject + V1 (s/es) + Object	Subject + does/do not + V1 + Object	Does/Do + Subject + V1 + Object?
Present Continuous	Subject + is/am/are + V1 + ing + Object	Subject + is/am/are not + V1 + ing + Object	Is/Am/Are + Subject + V1 + ing + Object?
Present Perfect	Subject + has/have + V3 + Object	Subject + has/have not + V3 + Object	Has/Have + Subject + V3 + Object?
Present Perfect Cont.	Subject + has/have been + V1 + ing + Obj	Subject + has/have not been + V1 + ing + Obj	Has/Have + Subject + been + V1 + ing + Obj?
Simple Past	Subject + V2 + Object	Subject + did not + V1 + Object	Did + Subject + V1 + Object?
Past Continuous	Subject + was/were + V1 + ing + Object	Subject + was/were not + V1 + ing + Object	Was/Were + Subject + V1 + ing + Object?
Past Perfect	Subject + had + V3 + Object	Subject + had not + V3 + Object	Had + Subject + V3 + Object?
Past Perfect Cont.	Subject + had been + V1 + ing + Object	Subject + had not been + V1 + ing + Object	Had + Subject + been + V1 + ing + Object?
Simple Future	Subject + will/shall + V1 + Object	Subject + will/shall not + V1 + Object	Will/Shall + Subject + V1 + Object?
Future Continuous	Subject + will/shall be + V1 + ing + Object	Subject + will/shall not be + V1 + ing + Object	Will/Shall + Subject + be + V1 + ing + Object?
Future Perfect	Subject + will/shall have + V3 + Object	Subject + will/shall not have + V3 + Object	Will/Shall + Subject + have + V3 + Object?
Future Perfect Cont.	Subject + will have been + V1 + ing + Object	Subject + will not have been + V1 + ing + Obj	Will + Subject + have been + V1 + ing + Obj?

PART 4: TENSE ERROR DETECTION EXERCISES

Spotting Errors

1. The students sitting on the dais, (A) / studied here (B) / for three years, but (C) / they have never created any problem. (D) / No Error (E)
2. A philogynist is a person (A) / who loves women (B) / but a misogynist is a person (C) / who is hating women. (D) / No Error (E)
3. It is appearing to me (A) / that you are (B) / trying to destabilize (C) / the present committee. (D) / No Error (E)
4. I have been knowing her (A) / for many years (B) / but I don't know (C) / where she works. (D) / No Error (E)
5. If he would have done this, (A) / he would have done wrong (B) / and would have deceived (C) / many of his relatives. (D) / No Error (E)
6. The victim tried to tell us (A) / what has happened (B) / but his words (C) / were not audible. (D) / No Error (E)
7. I want you to (A) / pick up the box of eggs gently (B) / and kept it in (C) / the corner carefully. (D) / No Error (E)
8. She came to (A) / the party much (B) / later than (C) / I expect. (D) / No Error (E)
9. I lived here (A) / for five years (B) / so I know about (C) / the problems of this colony. (D) / No Error (E)
10. The chairman had not taken (A) / any decision until (B) / he had studied (C) / the case thoroughly. (D) / No Error (E)
11. They got everything (A) / ready for the visitors (B) / long before (C) / they reached there. (D) / No Error (E)
12. He switched on (A) / the light before (B) / he entered (C) / the room. (D) / No Error (E)
13. I have been admiring (A) / her for the (B) / voice with which (C) / she is gifted. (D) / No Error (E)
14. He was with me (A) / uptil now, (B) / so don't (C) / punish him for the delay. (D) / No Error (E)
15. Several survey reports (A) / indicate that (B) / the number of (C) / drug addicts is grown gradually. (D) / No Error (E)
16. "Here is coming up Bachchan!" (A) / said he (B) / when he was (C) / waiting for him. (D) / No Error (E)
17. I could not recall (A) / when she has told me (B) / about her (C) / affair with Gopal. (D) / No Error (E)
18. Four and four (A) / always made eight, (B) / cannot (C) / be questioned by anyone. (D) / No Error (E)
19. She hopes to (A) / become an engineer (B) / after she will complete (C) / her education. (D) / No Error (E)

20. Shreya (A) / gave (B) / me (C) / the watch. (D) / No Error (E)

21. When you will find (A) / a solution to this problem, (B) / you will be able (C) / to get this project. (D) / No Error (E)

22. The teacher told us (A) / that we should remain (B) / in the hostel (C) / if it rains. (D) / No Error (E)

23. I could not recall (A) / what she has (B) / advised me (C) / in this matter. (D) / No Error (E)

24. By this time tomorrow (A) / she has had (B) / reached there positively. (C) / No Error (D)

25. I will inform (A) / you as soon as (B) / I will get any news (C) / about his health. (D) / No Error (E)

26. A recent survey (A) / indicates (B) / that the number of drug addicts (C) / grew day by day. (D) / No Error (E)

27. Before the alarm (A) / had stopped ringing, (B) / Reena had pulled up the shade. (C) / No Error (D)

28. If I was you (A) / I would have told (B) / the principal (C) / to keep his mouth shut. (D) / No Error (E)

29. I want you (A) / to pick up the box (B) / of glasses gently (C) / and kept it on the table carefully. (D) / No Error (E)

30. The victim tried (A) / to tell us what has happened (B) / but his words (C) / were not audible. (D) / No Error (E)

Detailed Answer Key and Explanations

1. (B) — Replace studied with have studied. A continuous residence extending into the present requires the present perfect.

2. (D) — Replace who is hating with who hates. Stative emotional verbs do not take continuous aspect.

3. (A) — Replace It is appearing with It appears. Appear as a copular verb is stative.

4. (A) — Replace have been knowing with have known. Know is stative and resists continuous tenses.

5. (A) — Replace If he would have done with If he had done. Third conditional protases demand if + past perfect.

6. (B) — Replace what has happened with what had happened to maintain past narrative sequence.

7. (C) — Replace kept it with keep it to preserve parallel structure with the bare infinitive pick up.

8. (D) — Replace I expect with I had expected for an expectation formed prior to the arrival.

9. (A) — Replace I lived with I have lived to convey duration continuing to the present.

10. (A) — Replace had not taken with did not take. A main clause takes simple past when the until-clause has past perfect.

11. (A) — Replace got with had got. Indicates an action completed prior to another past event (reached).

12. (E) — No Error. Sequential simple past actions are grammatically valid.

13. (A) — Replace have been admiring with admire. Admire expressing a settled opinion is stative.

14. (A) — Replace was with has been. The temporal marker uptil now requires the present perfect.

15. (D) — Replace is grown with is growing to describe an active, gradual change.

16. (A) — Replace with "Here comes Bachchan!" Exclamations introduced by here/there take the simple present.

17. (B) — Replace she has told with she had told to reflect anterior past action.

18. (B) — Replace made with makes. Universal mathematical facts take the simple present.

19. (C) — Replace will complete with completes or has completed. Subordinate time clauses reject future modals.

20. (D) — Replace the watch with a watch unless referring to an established item.

21. (A) — Replace When you will find with When you find. Temporal when-clauses use present forms for future meaning.

22. (D) — Replace if it rains with if it rained to maintain past tense harmony in reported speech.

23. (B) — Replace she has with she had to align with the past reporting verb recalled.

24. (B) — Replace has had with will have. A future deadline marker (by this time tomorrow) requires future perfect.

25. (C) — Replace I will get with I get. Subordinate time clauses introduced by as soon as omit will.

26. (D) — Replace grew with is growing to show active progression indicated by day by day.

27. (B) — Replace had stopped with stopped. The later past action takes simple past; the antecedent action takes past perfect.

28. (A) — Replace If I was with If I were. Counterfactual subjunctive clauses require were.

29. (D) — Replace kept with keep to maintain parallel infinitive structure with pick.

30. (B) — Replace what has happened with what had happened to match the past tense anchor tried.

PART 5: VOCABULARY BUILDING

Root Words, Prefixes, and Suffixes

No.	Affix / Root	Meaning	Examples
1	ab-	away; from	absent, abnormal, absorb
2	-able / -ible	capable of being	reversible, breakable, visible
3	ad-	to; toward	adhere, adjoin, adapt
4	-al	relating to	herbal, factual, seasonal

No.	Affix / Root	Meaning	Examples
5	ambi- / amb-	both; around	ambient, ambiguous, ambidextrous
6	ante-	before	anterior, antebellum, antecedent
7	anthrop-	human	anthropology, misanthrope, philanthropist
8	anti-	against; opposing	antibiotic, antisocial, antifreeze
9	aqu-	water	aquarium, aqueduct, aquifer
10	ast- / aster-	star	astronomy, astrology, asteroid
11	aud-	hear	audio, audience, auditorium
12	auto-	self	autograph, automobile, autobiography
13	bene- / ben-	good; well	benefit, benign, benevolent
14	bi-	two	bicycle, bilingual, bisect
15	bio-	life	biology, biography, biopsy
16	cent-	hundred	century, percent, centipede
17	chron-	time	chronic, chronological, chronicle
18	circum-	around	circumvent, circumscribe, circumference

No.	Affix / Root	Meaning	Examples
19	co- / con-	with; together	construct, collaborate, confer
20	counter-	opposing	counterbalance, counterfeit, counteract
21	cred-	believe	incredible, discredit, credence
22	cycl-	circle	recycle, bicycle, cyclone
23	dec-	ten	decade, decimal, decibel
24	dem-	people	democracy, demographics, epidemic
25	di- / du-	two	duet, dissect, dialogue
26	dia-	across; through	dialogue, diameter, diagnosis
27	dict-	speak; say	dictionary, dictate, contradict
28	dis-	not; apart	disagree, disinfect, disobey
29	-ence / -ance	state; quality	performance, conference, insurance
30	equ-	equal	equator, equality, equation
31	ex-	out; former	ex-president, extract, expatriate
32	fer-	carry; bear	transfer, conifer, aquifer

No.	Affix / Root	Meaning	Examples
33	frac- / frag-	break	fraction, fragment, fragile
34	-ful	full of	thoughtful, painful, helpful
35	gen-	birth; produce	gene, gender, genesis
36	geo-	earth	geology, geode, geography
37	grad- / gress-	step; move	graduation, graduate, gradual
38	graph-	write	paragraph, calligraphy, autograph
39	hydr-	water	hydrate, hydrogen, hydroplane
40	hyper-	excessive; over	hyperactive, hyperlink, hyperventilate
41	-ian	specialist; relating to	librarian, pedestrian, historian
42	-ic / -tic	having nature of	realistic, organic, metallic
43	-ile	capable of; tending to	reptile, sterile, juvenile
44	in- / im-	not; opposite	incapable, incomplete, inaudible
45	inter-	between; among	internet, intermission, international
46	intra-	within	intrastate, intramural, intrapersonal
47	-ism	doctrine; belief	racism, tourism, journalism

No.	Affix / Root	Meaning	Examples
48	-ist	one who practices	soloist, artist, cyclist
49	-ity	state; condition	creativity, disability, equality
50	ject-	throw	eject, reject, interject
51	junct-	join	juncture, junction, adjunct
52	-less	without	homeless, useless, wireless
53	log-	word; discourse	monologue, prologue, eulogy
54	-ly	in manner of	quickly, hourly, carefully
55	magn-	large; great	magnify, magnitude, magnificent
56	mal-	bad; ill	malady, malaria, malice
57	man-	hand	manicure, manage, manual
58	medi-	middle	mediocre, medium, medieval
59	mega-	large	megabyte, megaphone, megalith
60	meter-	measure	diameter, perimeter, thermometer
61	micro-	small	microscope, microwave, microbe
62	min-	less; small	miniature, minute, minimum

No.	Affix / Root	Meaning	Examples
63	mis-	wrong; bad	misbehave, misspell, miscount
64	miss- / mit-	send	missile, transmit, dismiss
65	mono-	one; single	monologue, monorail, monochrome
66	mort-	death	immortal, mortify, mortuary
67	multi-	many	multicolored, multilingual, multigrain
68	non-	not	nonviolent, nonstop, nonfiction
69	oct-	eight	octopus, octagon, octave
70	-ology	study of	biology, zoology, psychology
71	ortho-	straight; correct	orthodontist, orthopedic, orthodox
72	-ous	full of; possessing	virtuous, adventurous, hazardous
73	pan-	all	panorama, pandemic, pantheon
74	para-	beside; beyond	parallel, parasite, paramedic
75	path-	disease; feeling	pathogen, psychopath, sympathy
76	ped- / pod-	foot	pedal, pedestrian, pedometer

No.	Affix / Root	Meaning	Examples
77	-phobia	irrational fear	claustrophobia, hydrophobia, arachnophobia
78	phon-	sound	telephone, saxophone, microphone
79	photo-	light	photon, photography, photosynthesis
80	phys-	body; nature	physician, physical, physique
81	plex-	weave; fold	complex, cineplex, duplex
82	poly-	many	polygon, polytheism, polygraph
83	port-	carry	airport, transport, import
84	pos-	place; put	position, compose, deposit
85	post-	after	posterior, postscript, postpone
86	pre-	before	preview, prepay, previous
87	psych-	mind; soul	psychology, psychic, psychiatrist
88	quad-	four	quadruple, quadrant, quadratic
89	re-	again; back	rebuild, refund, renew
90	retro-	backward	retrospect, retroactive, retrograde

No.	Affix / Root	Meaning	Examples
91	rupt-	break	disrupt, interrupt, erupt
92	scope-	view; examine	periscope, telescope, microscope
93	scrib-	write	scribble, prescribe, manuscript
94	sect-	cut	section, dissect, intersect
95	semi-	half	semicircle, semifinal, semicolon
96	sens-	feel; perceive	sentimental, sensitive, consent
97	soci-	companion; society	sociology, social, associate
98	sol-	alone	solo, solitary, desolate
99	spec-	look; see	inspect, spectacle, spectator
100	spir-	breathe	conspire, inspire, respiratory
101	struct-	build	construction, structure, instruct
102	sub-	under; below	subway, submarine, subtitle
103	super-	above; beyond	superior, supervisor, superimpose
104	syn- / sym-	together; with	sympathy, synonym, symptom
105	techn-	craft; skill	technique, technology, technician

No.	Affix / Root	Meaning	Examples
106	tele-	distant	television, telephone, telescope
107	terr-	earth; land	terrain, terrace, territory
108	the- / theo-	god	theology, monotheism, polytheism
109	therm-	heat	thermometer, thermos, hypothermia
110	-tion	act; condition	infection, addition, celebration
111	tract-	pull; draw	attract, subtract, contraction
112	trans-	across; over	transform, transaction, translate
113	tri-	three	tripod, tricycle, triple
114	un-	not; reverse	unhappy, unhealthy, unsafe
115	uni-	one; single	unicycle, uniform, united
116	vac-	empty	vacuum, vacant, evacuate
117	ven- / vent-	come	prevent, venue, invent
118	vert- / vers-	turn	conversation, introvert, reverse
119	vid- / vis-	see	visible, video, television
120	zo-	animal	zoology, zookeeper, zodiac

PART 6: ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

Generic Terms

Abdication: An act of renouncing the throne or sovereign authority.

Almanac: An annual publication listing calendars, dates, and statistical data.

Amphibian: A cold-blooded vertebrate animal capable of living on both land and water.

Allegory: A story, poem, or picture with a hidden moral or political meaning.

Axiom: A statement or proposition accepted as self-evidently true without proof.

Belligerent: A nation, party, or person actively engaged in warfare or armed conflict.

Biopsy: Clinical removal and examination of living tissue to determine a pathology.

Blasphemy: The act or offense of speaking sacrilegiously against God or sacred things.

Chronology: The sequential arrangement of events in order of occurrence.

Crusade: A vigorous, concerted movement for social, political, or religious change.

Ephemeral: Lasting for a markedly brief duration; fleeting.

Extempore: Delivered, performed, or spoken without preparation.

Exonerate: To officially discharge and absolve someone from blame or criminal charges.

Gregarious: Fond of social company; convivial and outgoing.

Indelible: Making permanent marks that cannot be removed, washed away, or erased.

Infallible: Completely incapable of making mistakes or being wrong.

Inevitable: Certain to occur; incapable of being avoided or prevented.

Nostalgia: A sentimental yearning for happiness felt in a former place or time.

Panacea: A hypothetical universal remedy or solution for all diseases or problems.

Pantheism: A doctrine that identifies God directly with the universe and physical nature.

Pedantic: Overly concerned with minor rules, literal precision, or academic trivia.

Plagiarism: Appropriating someone else's work, language, or ideas and passing them off as one's own.

Potable: Pure, safe, and suitable for human consumption (referring to water).

Regalia: The distinctive emblems, decorations, and ceremonial symbols of royalty.

Sacrilege: The violation, desecration, or profane misuse of sacred places or things.

Sinecure: An office or position requiring minimal work yet offering financial compensation.

Souvenir: A tangible item preserved as a reminder of a place, person, or journey.

Utopia: An ideally imagined society, state, or political condition of total perfection.

Venial: Denoting a minor, excusable, or easily pardonable error or sin.

Verbatim: Repeated or recorded in the exact identical words as originally used.

Government and Political Systems

Anarchy: Absolute disorder and lawlessness resulting from the complete absence of recognized government.

Aristocracy: Form of government wherein sovereign power is concentrated in the hands of the noble class.

Autocracy: A political system ruled by a single individual possessing absolute, unconstrained power.

Autonomy: The sovereign condition of independent self-governance.

Bureaucracy: An administrative body characterized by rigid hierarchies, procedural red tape, and unelected officials.

Democracy: Governance wherein supreme authority is vested in the populace and exercised through elected representatives.

Gerontocracy: A political structure ruled exclusively by elderly individuals.

Kakistocracy: Government operated by the least qualified, most corrupt, and most unscrupulous citizens.

Neocracy: Governance administered by raw, inexperienced, and novice hands.

Ochlocracy: Mob rule; authority wielded by an uncontrolled crowd or populace.

Oligarchy: A small, exclusive clique exercising political or corporate control over an institution or nation.

Plutocracy: Governance directly characterized by the influence, control, or rule of the wealthy.

Secular: A system upholding complete neutrality and separation between civil affairs and religious doctrines.

Monarchy: Governance headed by an individual hereditary supreme sovereign (king, queen, or emperor).

Thearchy: A political system believed to be governed directly by divine command or supreme deities.

Venues, Spots, and Habitats

Archives: A dedicated depository preserving historical public documents, deeds, and official records.

Aviary: A large structural enclosure built to confine and observe birds.

Abattoir: A licensed commercial facility where livestock are slaughtered for meat.

Apiary: A designated location where beehives and bee colonies are maintained.

Aquarium: An artificial transparent installation designed for housing living aquatic specimens.

Arena: A level circular or oval open space surrounded by seating, dedicated to sports or public exhibitions.

Arsenal: A military storehouse dedicated to the manufacture, maintenance, and storage of arms and ammunition.

Asylum: An institution offering protective residential care to individuals experiencing mental illness.

Burrow: A subterranean tunnel or cavity excavated by small mammals like rabbits for sheltering.

Cache: A concealed hiding place used for securing valuable goods, treasures, or armaments.

Casino: A licensed public establishment dedicated to gambling and games of chance.

Cemetery: An extensive parcel of land set apart for burying deceased persons.

Cloakroom: A room designated for the attended temporary checking of outer garments, coats, and luggage.

Crematorium: A specialized architectural plant housing industrial incinerators for cremating cadavers.

Convent: A community building or estate occupied by religious women (nuns) bound by vows.

Crèche: A day-care nursery offering supervised care for infants and toddlers during working hours.

Decanter: An ornamental glass bottle, typically with a ground-glass stopper, used to serve wine or liquor.

Dormitory: A large communal sleeping hall containing multiple beds in educational or corporate institutions.

Drey: The compact nest built by an arboreal squirrel out of twigs within tree boughs.

Gymnasium: A spacious room or building equipped specifically for gymnastics and athletic conditioning.

Granary: A storehouse constructed specifically to preserve harvested grains against moisture and vermin.

Hangar: A massive covered building designed specifically to house, shelter, and repair aircraft.

Hutch: A wooden box-like cage fronted with wire mesh, built for keeping domesticated rabbits.

Infirmary: A designated room or clinic within an institution used to care for the unwell or injured.

Kennel: A small specialized wooden shelter or run built specifically for housing dogs.

Lair: The resting place, secluded retreat, or den of a wild, predatory animal.

Mint: An official government-authorized industrial facility where legal tender coins and currencies are manufactured.

Menagerie: A varied collection of wild or captive animals kept in cages for public presentation.

Monastery: A secluded community residence housing monks dedicated to religious contemplation.

Morgue: A refrigerated building or room where deceased bodies are held pending postmortem analysis or burial.

Orchard: An intentional agricultural planting of fruit- or nut-bearing trees.

Reservoir: An artificial or engineered lake constructed to accumulate and regulate water for civic distribution.

Scullery: A secondary back-room annex of a kitchen used for cleaning culinary pots, pans, and tableware.

Sheath: A fitted close scabbard serving as a protective shield for the blade of a knife, dagger, or sword.

Sanatorium: A specialized healthcare resort focused on treating long-term convalescents or chronic respiratory illnesses.

Tannery: An industrial site where animal skins and raw pelts are chemically cured and tanned into leather.

Wardrobe: A tall, upright piece of standalone furniture designed specifically for hanging garments.

Groups, Collectives, and Aggregations

Battery: A tactical grouping of heavy artillery pieces or missile launchers operating together.

Bale: A large bundle of raw fibers (such as cotton, wool, or hay) pressed and bound tightly with wire.

Bevy: A large aggregation of individuals, particularly women, or a flock of game birds.

Bouquet: An artistically gathered, arranged, and tied cluster of freshly cut flowers.

Brood: A collective family of young chicks, birds, or animals hatched or birthed at one time.

Caravan: A convoy of travelers, traders, or vehicles traveling together across open or hazardous country.

Caucus: A private consultative gathering convened by ranking members or delegates of a political party.

Clique: An exclusive, tight circle of associates bound by shared tastes who resist outside members.

Claque: A pre-arranged group of professional applauders paid to stimulate enthusiasm in a theatrical audience.

Constellation: A recognized, named pattern formed by a grouping of stellar celestial bodies.

Cortege: A solemn formal funeral procession consisting of mourners and accompanying vehicles.

Congregation: An assembled body of believers gathered together in an auditorium or church for worship.

Drove: A moving herd or flock of domesticated farm animals driven along together across distances.

Flotilla: A cohesive fleet composed of small naval warships, boats, or auxiliary watercraft.

Grove: A small natural cluster of trees growing clear of underbrush, often bearing fruit.

Hamlet: A tiny rustic settlement or rural residential cluster noticeably smaller than a village.

Herd: A collective assembly of large herbivorous mammals that feed or migrate together.

Horde: A vast, moving multitude of nomadic, undisciplined, or disruptive people.

Posse: A temporary group of armed citizens assembled by a sheriff or legal authority to enforce order.

Shoal: An enormous aggregate of fish swimming together in tight, dynamic coordination.

Torrent: A violently rushed, sudden, and overpowering stream of moving liquid or words.

Descriptions of Persons

Agnostic: One who maintains that nothing is known, or can be known, regarding the nature or existence of God.

Amateur: One who pursues an art, science, game, or sport strictly for pleasure rather than monetary compensation.

Ambidextrous: Capable of utilizing both the right and the left hands with equal mechanical skill and dexterity.

Anarchist: An advocate of disorder who rejects laws, statutory bodies, and established governmental rule.

Apostate: An individual who voluntarily renounces, abandons, or deserts their religion or political party.

Arbitrator: A chosen, neutral third-party individual authorized to judge and resolve a disputed contest.

Ascetic: One who exercises rigorous, disciplined self-denial and renounces sensual pleasures for spiritual devotion.

Atheist: One who consciously denies, rejects, or refutes the existence of an omnipotent creator or supreme deity.

Auditor: A qualified professional appointed to examine, verify, and report on organizational books of account.

Bohemian: An artistic individual who lives a socially free, unconventional life without concern for established norms.

Cacographer: A person characterized by consistently poor penmanship or chronic, deficient orthography.

Cannibal: A living creature that feeds upon the flesh and substance of members belonging to its own species.

Chauvinist: An individual demonstrating aggressive, uncritical, and blind partisanship toward their cause or group.

Coquette: A woman who makes flirtatious advances to attract men's attention without having sincere romantic intentions.

Connoisseur: A critical, discerning judge qualified to evaluate fine arts, delicacies, or gourmet cookery.

Contemporaries: Persons living, working, or existing alongside one another within the identical era.

Convalescent: An individual gradually recovering strength and health following severe illness or medical intervention.

Cosmopolitan: A worldly person who views the entire globe as their native country rather than identifying with one nation.

Cynic: One who expresses a deep, sneering distrust of general human motives, sincerity, and virtue.

Cynosure: An individual, structure, or focal point serving as the magnetic center of admiration or attention.

Debonair: A man marked by polished urbane charm, fashionable elegance, and confident ease.

Demagogue: A political leader who obtains power by appealing to popular desires and prejudices rather than rational argument.

Dilettante: A superficial dabbler in fine arts, music, or science who never attains master-level competence.

Effeminate: A man possessing physical habits, mannerisms, or characteristics culturally associated with women.

Egotist: A boastful person consumed by an excessive obsession with self-importance and personal successes.

Emigrant: One who leaves their native sovereign country to settle permanently in another land.

Epicure: A person with refined taste who takes luxury pleasure in fine dining and rare vintage wines.

Fanatic: An individual moved by unreasonable, extreme, and zealous fervor for an ideology or faith.

Fastidious: Painstakingly selective, meticulous, and exceedingly difficult to satisfy in matters of cleanliness or detail.

Fatalist: One who submits without struggle to the belief that every occurrence is predetermined by inescapable destiny.

Fugitive: One who runs away or flees from law enforcement, confinement, or active criminal prosecution.

Gourmand: One who takes hearty, excessive pleasure in consuming immense quantities of delicious food.

Henpecked: A husband chronically bullied, nagged, and commanded by his overbearing wife.

Heretic: A religious dissenter who upholds opinions contradicting accepted orthodox dogma.

Highbrow: An intellectual person who has or affects sophisticated tastes in literature, art, and philosophy.

Honorary: A title, award, or rank given as an honor without standard duties or monetary compensation.

Hypochondriac: A person troubled by continuous, groundless medical anxieties regarding imaginary personal diseases.

Iconoclast: A radical nonconformist who attacks revered traditional beliefs, cherished institutions, and religious icons.

Immoral: Lacking conformity to established ethical rules, accepted principles, or moral behaviors.

Impregnable: Inaccessible to capture, breach, or assault; impossible to defeat or persuade.

Indefatigable: Manifesting persistent, inexhaustible physical vigor and untiring stamina.

Insolvent: A debtor legally declared incapable of paying off their legitimate debts and financial liabilities; bankrupt.

Introvert: A quiet, inward-looking individual whose cognitive focus is drawn primarily toward their internal thoughts.

Lunatic: An individual suffering from dangerous psychiatric imbalance or acute mental madness.

Mercenary: A combatant or worker motivated strictly by personal monetary remuneration and reward.

Misanthrope: A reclusive individual who harbors deep hatred, distrust, and disdain toward human society.

Narcissist: An individual consumed by an excessive and inflated admiration of their own visual appearance or ego.

Numismatist: A serious collector, archivist, or scholar who studies coins, medals, and monetary tokens.

Pedantic: Narrowly, pretentiously, and obsessively attentive to scholarly details, rules, and textual definitions.

Philanthropist: A charitable benefactor who actively contributes wealth and time to improve the human condition.

Philogynist: An individual who respects, admires, and seeks to champion the dignity and welfare of women.

Polyglot: An individual capable of fluently speaking, reading, and writing across several distinct languages.

Recluse: A solitary person who withdraws entirely from everyday community interactions to live in isolation.

Somnambulist: An individual afflicted with the psychological condition of walking or performing tasks during deep sleep.

Stoic: One completely unaffected by pain, suffering, misfortune, joy, or emotional extremes.

Termagant: A harsh, ill-tempered, violently scolding, and quarrelsome woman.

Uxorious: Showing foolish, doting, and excessively submissive devotion toward one's wife.

Virtuoso: A musical or plastic artist gifted with supreme, master-level technical ability.

Terms Related to Death and Killing

Cortege: A formal funeral procession of attendants, mourners, and vehicles moving with a deceased individual.

Elegy: A sorrowful, reflective lyric poem composed to lament the passing of a deceased person.

Epitaph: A commemorative inscription carved on a mortuary monument or headstone in memory of the dead.

Filicide: The unlawful action of a parent killing their own son or daughter.

Foeticide: The intentional destruction or artificially induced medical termination of a developing fetus.

Fratricide: The deliberate act of slaying one's own brother.

Genocide: The planned, systematic extermination of an entire ethnic, racial, or religious group.

Homicide: The direct killing of one human being by another individual.

Infanticide: The intentional act of killing a newborn infant during the early stages of life.

Interment: The ritualized deposition of a deceased body inside a prepared grave or earthen tomb.

Matricide: The deliberate crime of killing one's own biological mother.

Mortuary: A specialized cold storage room or building used to hold corpses before burial or cremation.

Obituary: A published public chronicle detailing the life and announcing the passing of an individual.

Parricide: The crime of killing one's parent, guardian, or an immediate elderly relative.

Patricide: The deliberate crime of killing one's own biological father.

Postmortem: An exploratory anatomical autopsy carried out on a cadaver to verify the cause of death.

Regicide: The assassination or intentional slaying of a reigning monarch or royal sovereign.

Sororicide: The deliberate crime of killing one's own sister.

Suicide: The intentional act of ending one's own life.

Uxoricide: The criminal act of a husband murdering his own wife.

Professions and Fields of Study

Alchemy: A medieval chemical and philosophical pursuit focused on transmuting base metals into gold.

Anchor: A media professional responsible for coordinating and presenting news broadcasts or live programs.

Anthropologist: A scientist who studies human evolutionary origin, physical variations, and cultural adaptations.

Astronaut: A trained navigator certified to command, pilot, or serve on spacecraft voyages beyond the atmosphere.

Botany: The formal biological science devoted to the empirical investigation of plant physiology, anatomy, and ecology.

Calligrapher: An artist specializing in exquisite, ornamental, and high-grade aesthetic penmanship.

Cartographer: A technical compiler and draftsman skilled in constructing maps and geographic surveys.

Chauffeur: A professional driver hired to operate an automobile transporting passengers.

Choreographer: A creative artist who designs, composes, and directs structured movement sequences in dance.

Chronobiology: The biological science investigating cyclical rhythms and periodic timing processes in living organisms.

Compère: An entertainer who hosts, introduces artists, and coordinates variety programs and stage presentations.

Curator: The administrative keeper and scholarly custodian directing an art museum or archival collection.

Cypher: A mathematical or cryptological method used to convert clear plain text into encrypted code.

Dactylology: The structural manual communication technique utilizing finger patterns and hand signs for discourse.

Demography: The statistical scientific study of human populations, birth rates, migrations, and mortality curves.

Florist: A commercial merchant who arranges, manages, and retails fresh ornamental cut flowers and plants.

Genealogy: The historical science tracing human generational descents, lineage lineages, and ancestral lines.

Heliotherapy: Medical therapeutic exposure using controlled natural sunlight to treat physical diseases.

Horticulture: The applied branch of agricultural science focusing on the cultivation of orchard fruits, flowers, and vegetables.

Invigilator: An official monitor appointed to oversee examinees and maintain academic discipline in examination halls.

Jurisprudence: The theoretical study, systematic philosophy, and scientific understanding of law.

Lexicographer: A specialized linguistic scholar who compiles, indexes, defines, and publishes dictionaries.

Odontology: The professional medical study and therapeutic treatment of dental structures and oral diseases.

Petrology: The geological science investigating the structural origin, chemical makeup, and genesis of rocks.

Psephologist: A quantitative political scientist who statistically models and analyzes elections, ballots, and voter trends.

Radio Jockey: A media host who creates, presents, and manages radio transmissions, music, and spoken programming.

Rhetoric: The structural art of utilizing spoken or written discourse to persuade, inspire, and influence audiences.

Sculptor: A plastic fine artist who carves, molds, or models forms out of marble, stone, clay, wood, or bronze.

Zoology: The biological branch systematically investigating the classification, physiology, and behavior of animal kingdoms.

Animal Sounds and Acoustic Terms

Acoustics: The comprehensive branch of physical science investigating the generation, control, and transmission of sound.

Alligators: Bellow

Birds: Twitter

Camels: Grunt

Cattle: Moo

Crickets: Creak

Crows: Caw

Deer: Bell

Dolphins: Click

Ducks: Quack

Elephants: Trumpet

Frogs: Croak

Geese: Cackle

Hens: Cluck

Horses: Neigh

Monkeys: Gibber

Mosquitoes: Whine

Nightingales: Pipe

Owls: Hoot

Parrots: Screech

Penguins: Honk

Rats: Squeak

PART 7: ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTION PRACTICE EXERCISES

1. A fourteen-line poem
(1) sonnet (2) lyric (3) ballad (4) ode
Answer: (1) sonnet

2. The plants and vegetation of a region
(1) flora (2) landscape (3) ornamental (4) fauna
Answer: (1) flora

3. Constant effort to achieve something
(1) attempt (2) enthusiasm (3) vigour (4) perseverance
Answer: (4) perseverance

4. Wildly unreasonable, illogical or ridiculous
(1) abject (2) adept (3) arid (4) absurd

Answer: (4) absurd

5. A vivacious and lively experience is said to be
(1) scintillating (2) soothing (3) scenic (4) synthetic
Answer: (1) scintillating

6. To try to settle a dispute between two other parties
(1) medicate (2) mediate (3) meddle (4) meditate
Answer: (2) mediate

7. To secure a boat by attaching it to an anchor
(1) moor (2) moot (3) morose (4) moose
Answer: (1) moor

8. To free a person by a verdict of 'not guilty'
(1) acquaint (2) acquit (3) acquiesce (4) acquire
Answer: (2) acquit

9. One who hates mankind
(1) philanthropist (2) misogynist (3) humanitarian (4) misanthrope
Answer: (4) misanthrope

10. Imposed a restriction on
(1) constipated (2) conserved (3) constrained (4) construed
Answer: (3) constrained

11. Unwelcome aspect of a situation
(1) flippant (2) flip side (3) flip-flop (4) flintlock
Answer: (2) flip side

12. Feeling annoyed at the sight of unfair treatment
(1) indifferent (2) indisposed (3) indignant (4) indigent
Answer: (3) indignant

13. Walking in sleep
(1) somnambulism (2) insomnia (3) somnolence (4) sleepyhead
Answer: (1) somnambulism

14. Artistic, musical or dramatic interpretation
(1) rendition (2) report (3) imitation (4) reparation
Answer: (1) rendition

15. That which cannot be avoided
(1) infallible (2) inestimable (3) indifferent (4) inevitable
Answer: (4) inevitable

16. A person who leaves his own country in order to go and live in another
(1) emigrant (2) refugee (3) immigrant (4) expatriate

Answer: (1) emigrant

17. Showing a dislike of anything improper
(1) strict (2) crude (3) prim (4) rude
Answer: (3) prim

18. A planned route or journey
(1) iterate (2) itinerary (3) itinerant (4) isolate
Answer: (2) itinerary

19. A person who helps a stranger or a person in difficulties
(1) a Samaritan (2) a mercenary (3) a stoic (4) an altruist
Answer: (1) a Samaritan

20. Speech of great importance and gravity
(1) maiden (2) momentous (3) monumental (4) momentary
Answer: (2) momentous

21. Continuing for a long period of time without interruption
(1) continuum (2) recurring (3) perpetual (4) frequenting
Answer: (3) perpetual

22. Specially skilled in storytelling
(1) a compositor (2) a raconteur (3) a vocalist (4) a narrator
Answer: (2) a raconteur

23. Medical study of skin and its diseases
(1) orthopaedics (2) dermatology (3) endocrinology (4) gynaecology
Answer: (2) dermatology

24. A process involving too much official formality
(1) nepotism (2) diplomacy (3) bureaucracy (4) red-tapism
Answer: (4) red-tapism

25. A person who enters without any invitation
(1) vandal (2) burglar (3) intruder (4) thief
Answer: (3) intruder

26. Not suitable for eating
(1) spicy (2) tasteless (3) uneatable (4) inedible
Answer: (4) inedible

27. A recurrent compulsive urge to steal
(1) kleptomania (2) pneumonia (3) insomnia (4) nymphomania
Answer: (1) kleptomania

28. Act of injuring another's reputation by slanderous communication
(1) defamation (2) orchestration (3) aberration (4) misrepresentation

Answer: (1) defamation

29. A story in which animals or objects speak and give a moral lesson
(1) legend (2) fable (3) parable (4) allegory
Answer: (2) fable

30. One who does not believe in the existence of God
(1) atheist (2) theist (3) mystic (4) cynic
Answer: (1) atheist

PART 8: FILL IN THE BLANKS (TENSES)

1. Although I _____ (finish) my homework, I still don't understand this.
(a) finishes (b) finished (c) have finished (d) had finished
Answer: (c) have finished

2. What _____ (you do) when you saw her?
(a) will you do (b) had you do (c) have you did (d) did you do
Answer: (d) did you do

3. I _____ (not know) she used to be married.
(a) did not know (b) had not known (c) have not known (d) has not known
Answer: (a) did not know

4. I _____ (move) into this house in 2003.
(a) had moved (b) have moved (c) moved (d) moves
Answer: (c) moved

5. Before I _____ (meet) him, I was very lonely.
(a) met (b) have met (c) meet (d) had met
Answer: (a) met

6. Amit _____ (be) in Africa.
(a) am (b) have been (c) has been (d) will has been
Answer: (c) has been

7. I think she _____ (not see) us yesterday at the movies.
(a) have not saw (b) not seen (c) did not see (d) had not seen
Answer: (c) did not see

8. I _____ (just think) of a good idea! Let's...
(a) just thought (b) have just thought (c) just think (d) had just thought
Answer: (b) have just thought

9. I _____ (not be) at school last week.
(a) am not (b) did not (c) was not (d) be not
Answer: (c) was not

10. How long _____ (you / live) there before coming here?
(a) did you live (b) have you lived (c) had you lived (d) you lived
Answer: (c) had you lived

11. She _____ (never eat) an octopus.
(a) have not eaten (b) have never eaten (c) has ever eaten (d) has never eaten
Answer: (d) has never eaten

12. I don't think she _____ (do) her homework.
(a) had been done (b) has done (c) done (d) was done
Answer: (b) has done

13. Anita _____ (believe) that for ages.
(a) believed (b) had been believed (c) has believed (d) have believed
Answer: (c) has believed

14. I am not hungry. I _____ (eat / already).
(a) was already eaten (b) have already eaten (c) had already eaten (d) had eaten already
Answer: (b) have already eaten

15. I _____ (work) here for 3 years now.
(a) worked (b) working (c) have been working (d) had been working
Answer: (c) have been working

16. I cannot remember when was the last time I _____ (be) here.
(a) be (b) become (c) was (d) was being
Answer: (c) was

17. He _____ (live) here since 1990.
(a) had lived (b) have lived (c) lived (d) has lived
Answer: (d) has lived

18. When was the last time you _____ (call) her?
(a) have called (b) called (c) had called (d) has called
Answer: (b) called

19. Yesterday she _____ (get) a new bed.
(a) gets (b) had get (c) got (d) have got
Answer: (c) got

20. _____ (ever be) to Chicago?
(a) Ever been (b) Has ever been (c) Have you ever been (d) Had you ever been
Answer: (c) Have you ever been

21. The brilliant students will be _____ scholarships.
(a) honored (b) awarded
Answer: (b) awarded

Synonyms & Antonyms

#	Target Word	Meaning & Definition	Key Synonyms	Key Antonyms
1	**Acumen**	Mental sharpness, quickness in insight	Shrewdness, Perspicacity, Astuteness	Ignorance, Naivety, Stupidity
2	**Alleviate**	To make suffering or a problem less severe	Mitigate, Relieve, Palliate, Ease	Aggravate, Exacerbate, Worsen
3	**Ambiguous**	Open to more than one interpretation	Equivocal, Obscure, Vague, Cryptic	Clear, Explicit, Lucid, Unambiguous
4	**Ameliorate**	To make something bad or unsatisfactory better	Enhance, Improve, Upgrade, Amend	Deteriorate, Worsen, Impair

#	Target Word	Meaning & Definition	Key Synonyms	Key Antonyms
5	**Anomalous**	Deviating from what is standard, normal, or expected	Aberrant, Atypical, Irregular	Standard, Normal, Conventional, Regular
6	**Apathy**	Lack of interest, enthusiasm, or concern	Indifference, Lethargy, Detachment	Enthusiasm, Passion, Fervor, Zeal
7	**Arbitrary**	Based on random choice or personal whim	Capricious, Discretionary, Random	Systematic, Rational, Objective, Fair
8	**Assiduous**	Showing great care, attention, and effort	Diligent, Meticulous, Industrious	Lazy, Negligent, Careless, Idle
9	**Audacious**	Showing a willingness to take bold risks	Intrepid, Daring, Valiant, Bold	Timid, Cowardly, Cautious, Meek
10	**Augment**	To make greater by adding to it; increase	Amplify, Expand, Boost, Multiply	Diminish, Deplete, Reduce, Curtail
11	**Benevolent**	Well-meaning, kindly, and charitable	Altruistic, Philanthropic, Generous	Malevolent, Spiteful, Hostile
12	**Bolster**	To support, strengthen, or prop up	Reinforce, Fortify, Buttress, Sustain	Undermine, Weaken, Compromise
13	**Candid**	Truthful, direct, and straightforward	Frank, Sincere, Forthright, Blunt	Deceitful, Evasive, Disingenuous

#	Target Word	Meaning & Definition	Key Synonyms	Key Antonyms
14	**Capitulate**	To cease resisting an opponent; surrender	Concede, Yield, Relinquish, Succumb	Resist, Defy, Persevere, Conquer
15	**Censure**	To express severe disapproval or harsh criticism	Rebuke, Reprimand, Condemn, Chastise	Praise, Commend, Applaud, Endorse
16	**Coerce**	To persuade someone to do something using force/threats	Compel, Intimidate, Pressurize	Persuade, Entreat, Allow, Induce
17	**Complacent**	Smug or uncritically satisfied with oneself	Self-satisfied, Unconcerned, Smug	Ambitious, Vigilant, Discontent, Driven
18	**Concur**	To be of the same opinion; agree	Accord, Harmonize, Consent, Agree	Dissent, Disagree, Dispute, Differ
19	**Conducive**	Making a certain situation or outcome likely/possible	Favorable, Beneficial, Contributory	Hindering, Deleterious, Adverse
20	**Curtail**	To reduce in extent, quantity, or limit	Truncate, Diminish, Restrict, Abbreviate	Extend, Expand, Lengthen, Prolong
21	**Deference**	Humble submission and respect	Veneration, Reverence, Esteem, Homage	Disrespect, Insolence, Contempt, Defiance

#	Target Word	Meaning & Definition	Key Synonyms	Key Antonyms
22	**Deterrent**	A thing that discourages someone from doing something	Disincentive, Impediment, Restraint	Incentive, Catalyst, Encouragement
23	**Diligent**	Showing persistent and hardworking effort	Conscientious, Painstaking, Meticulous	Slothful, Careless, Neglectful
24	**Disparate**	Fundamentally distinct or not allowing comparison	Divergent, Contrastive, Incompatible	Homogeneous, Identical, Similar, Uniform
25	**Elucidate**	To make clear; explain thoroughly	Clarify, Expound, Illuminate, Demystify	Confuse, Obscure, Confound, Muddle
26	**Empathy**	Ability to understand and share feelings of another	Compassion, Sensitivity, Affinity	Callousness, Apathy, Insensitivity
27	**Equivocal**	Ambiguous, uncertain, or open to dispute	Dubious, Evasive, Vague, Cryptic	Unequivocal, Plain, Clear, Definite
28	**Exacerbate**	To make a problem, situation, or negative feeling worse	Aggravate, Inflame, Intensify, Worsen	Soothe, Mitigate, Pacify, Relieve
29	**Exemplary**	Serving as a desirable model; outstanding	Meritorious, Commendable, Archetypal	Reprehensible, Flawed, Substandard

#	Target Word	Meaning & Definition	Key Synonyms	Key Antonyms
30	**Expedite**	To make an action or process happen sooner	Accelerate, Quicken, Hasten, Precipitate	Delay, Impede, Hinder, Obstruct
31	**Facetious**	Treating serious issues with deliberately inappropriate humor	Fippant, Jocular, Whimsical, Glib	Solemn, Serious, Grave, Earnest
32	**Feasible**	Possible and practical to do easily or conveniently	Viable, Achievable, Workable, Practical	Impracticable, Unfeasible, Impossible
33	**Frugal**	Prudent, sparing, or economical with money/resources	Thrifty, Parsimonious, Economical	Extravagant, Profligate, Wasteful
34	**Gullible**	Easily persuaded to believe something; naive	Credulous, Impressionable, Unwary	Astute, Skeptical, Cynical, Shrewd
35	**Hamper**	To hinder or impede the movement or progress of	Obstruct, Thwart, Clog, Inhibit	Facilitate, Assist, Aid, Expedite
36	**Implicit**	Implied though not plainly expressed	Tacit, Unstated, Inherent, Indirect	Explicit, Stated, Direct, Expressed
37	**Indigenous**	Originating or occurring naturally in a particular place	Native, Aboriginal, Endemic, Local	Exotic, Alien, Foreign, Introduced

#	Target Word	Meaning & Definition	Key Synonyms	Key Antonyms
38	**Juxtapose**	To place different things together to contrast them	Collocate, Compare, Contrast	Separate, Isolate, Disconnect
39	**Lucid**	Expressed clearly; easy to understand	Intelligible, Articulate, Transparent, Clear	Incoherent, Vague, Obscure, Confused
40	**Meticulous**	Showing great attention to detail; very careful	Scrupulous, Precise, Punctilious, Exact	Sloppy, Negligent, Slipshod, Careless
41	**Mitigate**	To make less severe, serious, or painful	Attenuate, Modulate, Subdue, Lessen	Intensify, Exacerbate, Aggravate
42	**Obsolete**	No longer produced or used; out of date	Antiquated, Archaic, Superannuated	Contemporary, Modern, State-of-the-art
43	**Plausible**	Seeming reasonable or probable	Credible, Believable, Probable, Tenable	Implausible, Dubious, Inconceivable
44	**Pragmatic**	Dealing with things sensibly and realistically	Practical, Utilitarian, Hardheaded	Idealistic, Quixotic, Unrealistic
45	**Redundant**	No longer needed or useful; superfluous	Superfluous, Surplus, Dispensable	Essential, Indispensable, Vital, Crucial
46	**Resilient**	Able to withstand or recover quickly from difficulty	Buoyant, Robust, Tenacious, Adaptable	Fragile, Vulnerable, Brittle, Delicate

#	Target Word	Meaning & Definition	Key Synonyms	Key Antonyms
47	**Substantiate**	To provide evidence to support or prove the truth of	Corroborate, Validate, Authenticate, Verify	Refute, Disprove, Debunk, Invalidate
48	**Taciturn**	Reserved or uncommunicative in speech; saying little	Reticent, Laconic, Untalkative, Silent	Loquacious, Garrulous, Voluble, Talkative
49	**Tenacious**	Holding fast; persistent and determined	Resolute, Pertinacious, Persistent, Dogged	Irresolute, Wavering, Faltering, Yielding
50	**Vindicate**	To clear someone of blame or suspicion; justify	Exonerate, Absolve, Acquit, Justify	Incriminate, Blame, Condemn, Convict

Module 2: 50 Confusing Homophones & Commonly Confused Word Pairs

Targeted for sentence correction, error spotting, and professional email correspondence.

#	Homophone Pair / Group	Distinct Definitions & Clarification	Contextual Example in Corporate / Engineering Setting
1	**Accept / Except**	Accept: to receive willingly | Except: excluding or apart from	She will accept the job offer; all candidates cleared the interview except Rohan.
2	**Access / Excess**	Access: permission/ability to enter | Excess: an amount beyond what is needed	He was granted server access, but deleted the excess backup log files.

#	Homophone Pair / Group	Distinct Definitions & Clarification	Contextual Example in Corporate / Engineering Setting
3	**Advice / Advise**	Advice (noun): guidance or recommendation | Advise (verb): to give counsel	Take the mentor's technical advice seriously when they advise code optimization.
4	**Affect / Effect**	Affect (verb): to influence | Effect (noun): the result or impact	System latency will affect users; the direct effect is increased bounce rate.
5	**Allude / Elude**	Allude: to refer to indirectly | Elude: to escape or evade cleverness	He alluded to market conditions, but the exact solution eluded the team.
6	**Altar / Alter**	Altar: a sacred table or platform | Alter: to modify or change	We do not need to alter the database architecture for the new UI schema.
7	**Assent / Ascent**	Assent: official agreement or approval | Ascent: a rise or climb upward	Management gave assent to the budget, marking the project's rapid ascent.
8	**Bare / Bear**	Bare: uncovered or plain | Bear: to endure/carry (or large animal)	The bare truth is that legacy hardware cannot bear enterprise workloads.
9	**Brake / Break**	Brake: device for slowing down | Break: to shatter, sever, or take a pause	Apply the vehicle brake firmly; let's take a short coffee break after testing.

#	Homophone Pair / Group	Distinct Definitions & Clarification	Contextual Example in Corporate / Engineering Setting
10	**Buy / By / Bye**	Buy: to purchase | By: near/through/agent | Bye: farewell / pass	We need to buy new cloud licenses by Friday before bidding farewell.
11	**Canvas / Canvass**	Canvas: heavy woven fabric | Canvass: to solicit votes or survey opinions	The booth had a heavy canvas backdrop; HR will canvass feedback today.
12	**Capital / Capitol**	Capital: seat of govt, financial assets, upper case | Capitol: legislative building	The tech startup secured seed capital to open an office near the state capitol.
13	**Censor / Sensor / Censure**	Censor: suppress speech | Sensor: detector device | Censure: reprimand	The IoT sensor triggered an alert, causing management to censure poor security.
14	**Cite / Site / Sight**	Cite: to quote/reference | Site: a physical/web location | Sight: ability to see	Please cite proper documentation before deploying code to the client site.
15	**Coarse / Course**	Coarse: rough in texture or crude | Course: path, program of study	The engineer smoothed the coarse finish; he enrolled in a Python course.
16	**Compliment / Complement**	Compliment: praise or admiration | Complement: completing/enhancing pair	She gave him a compliment on his code, which complemented the front-end design.

#	Homophone Pair / Group	Distinct Definitions & Clarification	Contextual Example in Corporate / Engineering Setting
17	**Council / Counsel**	Council: an advisory or governing body | Counsel: advice or attorney	The academic council sought legal counsel before revising patent guidelines.
18	**Cue / Queue**	Cue: a hint, signal, or prompt | Queue: a line of waiting people or tasks	On cue, the server began processing print jobs in the execution queue.
19	**Descent / Dissent**	Descent: downward movement or ancestry | Dissent: difference of opinion	The aircraft made a rapid descent; one panelist expressed dissent on the verdict.
20	**Discreet / Discrete**	Discreet: careful, prudent, tactful | Discrete: separate, distinct elements	Keep salary talks discreet; the database stores data in discrete chunks.
21	**Draft / Draught**	Draft: preliminary version or selection | Draught: current of air / drawing liquid	Review the rough draft of the design specification before sending it.
22	**Dual / Duel**	Dual: consisting of two parts | Duel: combat between two competitors	The laptop has dual monitors; the tech giants entered a patent duel.
23	**Elicit / Illicit**	Elicit: to evoke or draw out a response | Illicit: forbidden by law or rules	Good interviewers elicit insightful answers; illicit data sharing is strictly penalized.

#	Homophone Pair / Group	Distinct Definitions & Clarification	Contextual Example in Corporate / Engineering Setting
24	**Emigrate / Immigrate**	Emigrate: to leave one's own country | Immigrate: to come to live in a new one	Engineers who emigrate from India often immigrate to Canada or Germany.
25	**Ensure / Insure / Assure**	Ensure: make certain | Insure: protect against loss | Assure: promise/convince	Ensure unit tests run, insure valuable server hardware, and assure the client.
26	**Faze / Phase**	Faze: to disturb or disconcert | Phase: a distinct period or project stage	Difficult interview questions did not faze him during phase one of hiring.
27	**Flair / Flare**	Flair: natural talent or aptitude | Flare: sudden burst of flame or anger	She has a flair for cloud architecture; solar flares can disrupt GPS.
28	**Foreword / Forward**	Foreword: introductory note in a book | Forward: onward or front direction	The CTO wrote the foreword for the book; please forward the slide deck.
29	**Grate / Great**	Grate: shred or make harsh sound; framework | Great: of large size or excellence	The metallic noise began to grate on nerves; the developer did a great job.
30	**Heal / Heel**	Heal: become sound or healthy | Heel: back part of the human foot	Consistent rest helps heal injuries; the server rack was tilted off its heel.

#	Homophone Pair / Group	Distinct Definitions & Clarification	Contextual Example in Corporate / Engineering Setting
31	**Hear / Here**	Hear: perceive with the ear | Here: in, at, or to this place	Can you hear the audio clearly? All panel members are gathered here.
32	**Hoard / Horde**	Hoard: amass and hide valuables | Horde: a large disorderly crowd	Do not hoard computing resources; a horde of users logged into the portal.
33	**Lead / Led**	Lead: heavy metal element / guide (rhymes with bead) | Led: past tense of lead	Pipes should not contain lead; the tech lead led his team to victory.
34	**Lesson / Lessen**	Lesson: period of learning | Lessen: to reduce or diminish	The post-mortem was a valuable lesson that will lessen future production bugs.
35	**Loose / Lose**	Loose: not firmly fixed or tight | Lose: to be deprived of or fail to retain	Fix that loose network cable immediately so the terminal does not lose connection.
36	**Marry / Merry**	Marry: join in matrimony / combine | Merry: cheerful and lively	The startup will marry AI with healthcare; the celebration had a merry vibe.
37	**Moral / Morale**	Moral: concerned with right vs wrong | Morale: team confidence and spirit	High moral standards build trust; successful product launches boost team morale.

#	Homophone Pair / Group	Distinct Definitions & Clarification	Contextual Example in Corporate / Engineering Setting
38	**Passed / Past**	Passed: moved beyond (past of pass) | Past: gone in time / previous events	He easily passed the coding evaluation, reflecting on past interview attempts.
39	**Peak / Peek / Pique**	Peak: sharp summit/highest point | Peek: quick look | Pique: stimulate interest/resentment	Traffic hit its peak at noon; take a peek at the log files to pique curiosity.
40	**Persecute / Prosecute**	Persecute: subject to hostility/ill-treatment | Prosecute: conduct legal proceedings	Do not persecute whistleblowers; the firm will prosecute IP theft.
41	**Precede / Proceed**	Precede: to come before in time or order | Proceed: to move forward with action	A security check must precede system entry before you proceed with installation.
42	**Principal / Principle**	Principal: head of organization or primary sum | Principle: fundamental rule/truth	The principal architect insists on following the SOLID design principles.
43	**Role / Roll**	Role: actor's part or assigned duty | Roll: cylinder or list of names / rotation	Her role as Scrum Master is to verify attendance during the morning roll call.
44	**Root / Route**	Root: source/base of plant or cause | Route: pathway or course	Identify the root cause of network latency along this internet traffic route.

#	Homophone Pair / Group	Distinct Definitions & Clarification	Contextual Example in Corporate / Engineering Setting
45	**Stationary / Stationery**	Stationary: not moving or remaining still | Stationery: writing materials/paper	The robot remained stationary while HR ordered branded desk stationery.
46	**Suite / Sweet**	Suite: set of rooms or software tools | Sweet: sugary taste or pleasant	The engineering suite includes developer tools; success after effort is sweet.
47	**Tier / Tear**	Tier: rank, level, or row | Tear: rip apart / drop of liquid from eye	This service uses a three-tier architecture; avoid errors that tear the fabric of trust.
48	**Vain / Vane / Vein**	Vain: conceited or futile | Vane: blade moved by wind | Vein: vessel carrying blood	His vain attempt failed to turn the wind vane; the mine hit a rich vein.
49	**Waive / Wave**	Waive: to voluntarily forfeit a right/claim | Wave: hand gesture or sea surge	Management agreed to waive the late fee with a polite wave of approval.
50	**Weather / Whether**	Weather: atmospheric conditions | Whether: expressing doubt or choice between two	Extreme weather delayed servers; determine whether to use AWS or Azure.

Module 3: 50 Core Corporate & Technical Vocabulary Terms for Interviews

High-impact terminology to elevate HR, managerial, and technical round conversations and behavioral scenarios.

#	Corporate Term	Definition & Professional Significance	Practical Interview / Workplace Example
1	**Actionable**	Information, insights, or steps capable of being acted upon directly	The quarterly performance review provided actionable feedback for the codebase.
2	**Agile**	Iterative project management approach emphasizing flexibility and team speed	Our development sprint follows Agile principles to deliver incremental sprint goals.
3	**Bandwidth**	Mental or physical capacity and available time to handle tasks	I lack the bandwidth this sprint to take on bug triage for the billing module.
4	**Benchmarking**	Evaluating performance against industry bests or historical metrics	Benchmarking API latency against competitors revealed the need for caching.
5	**Bottleneck**	A stage in a process that impedes or stalls total throughput	The single approval queue created a bottleneck in our continuous deployment pipeline.
6	**Burnout**	State of physical or mental exhaustion caused by prolonged stress	Rigorous on-call rotations without adequate recovery often precipitate developer burnout.

#	Corporate Term	Definition & Professional Significance	Practical Interview / Workplace Example
7	**Buy-in**	Gaining agreement, commitment, or active support from stakeholders	Securing executive buy-in is prerequisite to overhauling legacy mainframe systems.
8	**Change Management**	Systematic approach to dealing with transition or transformation in orgs	Proper change management minimized downtime during the ERP cloud migration.
9	**Client-Facing**	Roles, activities, or documentation dealing directly with customers	Engineers need polished presentation skills when stepping into client-facing roles.
10	**Deliverable**	A tangible product, service, or outcome required upon completion	The API specification doc is our key deliverable due before the milestone audit.
11	**Disruption**	Innovation that significantly transforms an industry or business model	Generative AI creates continuous disruption across legacy software testing paradigms.
12	**Due Diligence**	Comprehensive appraisal of an asset or company before signing a deal	The venture fund conducted rigorous technical due diligence on our patent code.
13	**Ecosystem**	Interconnected network of organizations, products, or technologies	The company is expanding its developer ecosystem by releasing public APIs.

#	Corporate Term	Definition & Professional Significance	Practical Interview / Workplace Example
14	**Elevator Pitch**	Brief, persuasive speech used to spark interest in a concept or project	Prepare a two-minute elevator pitch summarizing your final-year capstone project.
15	**Empirical**	Based on observation, measurement, or experiment rather than theory	We need empirical runtime benchmarks before concluding that Rust outperforms C++ here.
16	**Escalate**	To refer an issue or crisis to higher-level authorities or experts	When the production server crashed, the junior engineer escalated the ticket to L3.
17	**Feasibility Study**	Analysis of how successfully a project can be completed technically/financially	Our feasibility study verified that on-premise servers were less cost-effective.
18	**Holistic**	Characterized by the treatment or comprehension of the whole system	We conducted a holistic security review covering hardware, firmware, and UI code.
19	**KPI (Key Perf. Indicator)**	Quantifiable measure evaluating success in meeting operational targets	Sprint velocity and system uptime served as primary engineering KPIs.

#	Corporate Term	Definition & Professional Significance	Practical Interview / Workplace Example
20	**Leverage**	To use existing assets, tools, or resources to maximum advantage	We can leverage Docker containers to ensure consistent development environments.
21	**Liaison**	Communication facilitating close working relationship between entities	The tech lead served as an active liaison between product design and QA teams.
22	**Low-Hanging Fruit**	Tasks or goals easily achieved with minimal effort or risk	Compressing oversized image assets is low-hanging fruit for site speed.
23	**Mitigation Strategy**	Plan formulated to reduce risk, impact, or vulnerability	Having redundant AWS regions is our core mitigation strategy for outage prevention.
24	**Non-Disclosure Agreement**	Legally binding contract establishing confidential relationship	All prospective interns signed an NDA before viewing the proprietary codebase.
25	**Onboarding**	Mechanism through which new employees acquire requisite skills and culture	A structured two-week onboarding process helped the freshers deploy their first PR.
26	**Outsource**	Obtaining goods or services from an outside or third-party supplier	The firm decided to outsource UI localization to a specialized translation vendor.

#	Corporate Term	Definition & Professional Significance	Practical Interview / Workplace Example
27	**Paradigm Shift**	Fundamental change in basic concepts, methods, or practices	Serverless computing introduced a major paradigm shift in backend infrastructure.
28	**Pivot**	Fundamental shift in business or technical direction based on feedback	When web traffic plateaued, the startup engineered a pivot toward mobile SaaS.
29	**POC (Proof of Concept)**	Demonstration showing feasibility and verification of practical potential	Before full deployment, build a mini POC demonstrating websocket real-time sync.
30	**Proactive**	Creating or controlling a situation rather than just responding to it	Proactive monitoring prevents sudden CPU spikes from disrupting client sessions.
31	**RACI Matrix**	Chart defining roles: Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, and Informed	The project manager mapped the RACI matrix so task ownership was explicit.
32	**Redundancy**	Duplication of critical components or functions to increase reliability	Dual power supplies provide hardware redundancy against catastrophic grid loss.

#	Corporate Term	Definition & Professional Significance	Practical Interview / Workplace Example
33	**Resource Allocation**	Process of assigning and scheduling available assets across projects	Optimal resource allocation prevented talent starvation across critical sprints.
34	**Retrospective**	Review meeting held at the end of a sprint to analyze what went well and poorly	During the sprint retrospective, team members highlighted blockers in CI/CD.
35	**ROI (Return on Investment)**	Metric calculating the efficiency or profitability of an expenditure	Automated regression testing yielded a massive ROI by slashing bug discovery time.
36	**Scalability**	Capability of a system or process to handle growing amounts of work	Microservices architecture was selected specifically to guarantee horizontal scalability.
37	**Scope Creep**	Continuous growth or changes in project deliverables beyond original intent	Unchecked feature requests caused severe scope creep, delaying product rollout.
38	**Scrum**	Agile framework facilitating collaborative teamwork on complex software	The morning Scrum standup lasted exactly fifteen minutes to align task priorities.

#	Corporate Term	Definition & Professional Significance	Practical Interview / Workplace Example
39	**Silo**	System or department that operates in isolation from others	Breaking down information silos between developers and DevOps improved reliability.
40	**SLA (Service Level Agreement)**	Commitment between service provider and client regarding uptime/quality	Our SLA guarantees 99.95% system uptime and sub-hour critical bug resolution.
41	**Stakeholder**	Person or entity with an interest or concern in a business or project	Ensure major architectural revisions are signed off by all internal stakeholders.
42	**Synergy**	Combined effect greater than the sum of separate individual efforts	Cross-pollinating electrical and firmware engineers produced exceptional product synergy.
43	**Touchpoint**	Point of contact or interaction between an organization and a customer	Every automated onboarding email serves as a critical brand customer touchpoint.
44	**Turnaround Time (TAT)**	Total time taken between submission of a process and its completion	Optimizing the SQL queries lowered customer support ticket turnaround time.

#	Corporate Term	Definition & Professional Significance	Practical Interview / Workplace Example
45	**Value Proposition**	Feature or statement highlighting unique benefit delivered to users	Real-time edge computation is our product's primary value proposition.
46	**Vetting**	Subjecting someone or something to thorough appraisal or screening	Rigorous candidate vetting ensures technical competency and collaborative fit.
47	**Viability**	Ability of a product, concept, or business to survive and succeed practically	The financial viability of the hardware prototype depends on global chip prices.
48	**War Room**	Centralized, dedicated crisis space where teams solve urgent emergencies	The DevOps leads set up a physical war room to remediate the zero-day exploit.
49	**Workflow**	Sequence of industrial, administrative, or computing processes	Automating our code review workflow minimized merge conflicts across Git repos.
50	**Zero-Day**	Vulnerability unknown to developers or exploited before a patch exists	The security department patched the zero-day flaw within six hours of disclosure.

Strategic Preparation Tips for Engineering Students:

- **Elimination Technique in Written Aptitude:** When tackling synonym/antonym questions (e.g., in TCS NQT, Infosys, Capgemini), evaluate the tone (positive, negative, or neutral). Eliminate options with opposite connotations before analyzing subtleties.
- **Mastering Parts of Speech:** Watch out for word form traps (e.g., Advice [noun] vs. Advise [verb], Affect [verb] vs. Effect [noun]). Sentence completion and error-spotting questions frequently exploit part-of-speech mismatches.
- **STAR Method with Corporate Vocabulary:** During behavioral interviews, incorporate terms like Agile, bottleneck, root cause analysis, mitigation strategy, and KPI into your STAR (Situation, Task, Action, Result) responses to sound professional and industry-ready.